KELSEY WANG
WORKS @ GSAPP
2023-2026

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[1]---------- AFTER LEISURE

[2]---------- BY/PRODUCT

[3]---------- CARBON TEMPLES

[4]---------- SPECTACLE & SH-216

[5]---------- WHERE OBJECTS REST

[6]---------- 125 CORNER UNIVERSITY

AFTER LEISURE

SEMESTER:
ADV IV “Sanctuaries Territories”
Spring 2025

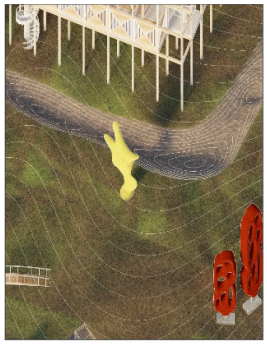
SITE:
Sleepy Hollow Country Club
Hudson Valley, NY

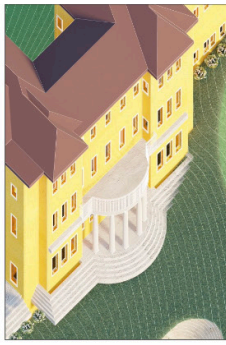
PARTNER:
Hannah Zhao

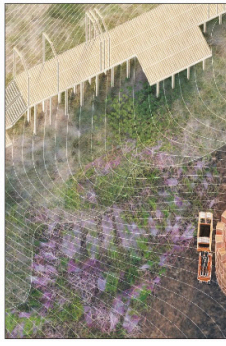
INSTRUCTOR:
Nahyun Hwang

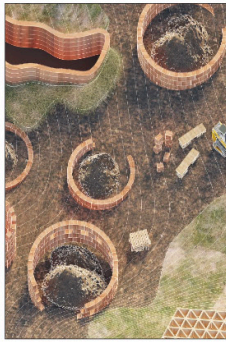
This project reimagines Sleepy Hollow Country Club as a fractured landscape of ecological, social, and spatial repair. Once upheld by exploitative labor systems and elite leisure, the site becomes a testing ground for new land uses rooted in care, conflict, and cohabitation.

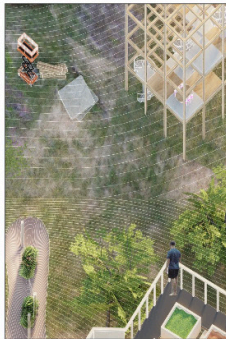
After Leisure examines the hidden labor and ecological systems that sustain recreational landscapes. Using the golf club as a case study, the project maps the asymmetry between visible enjoyment and invisible maintenance. Leisure is framed not as neutral pleasure, but as an economy structured by wages, seasonal work, land management, and environmental extraction.

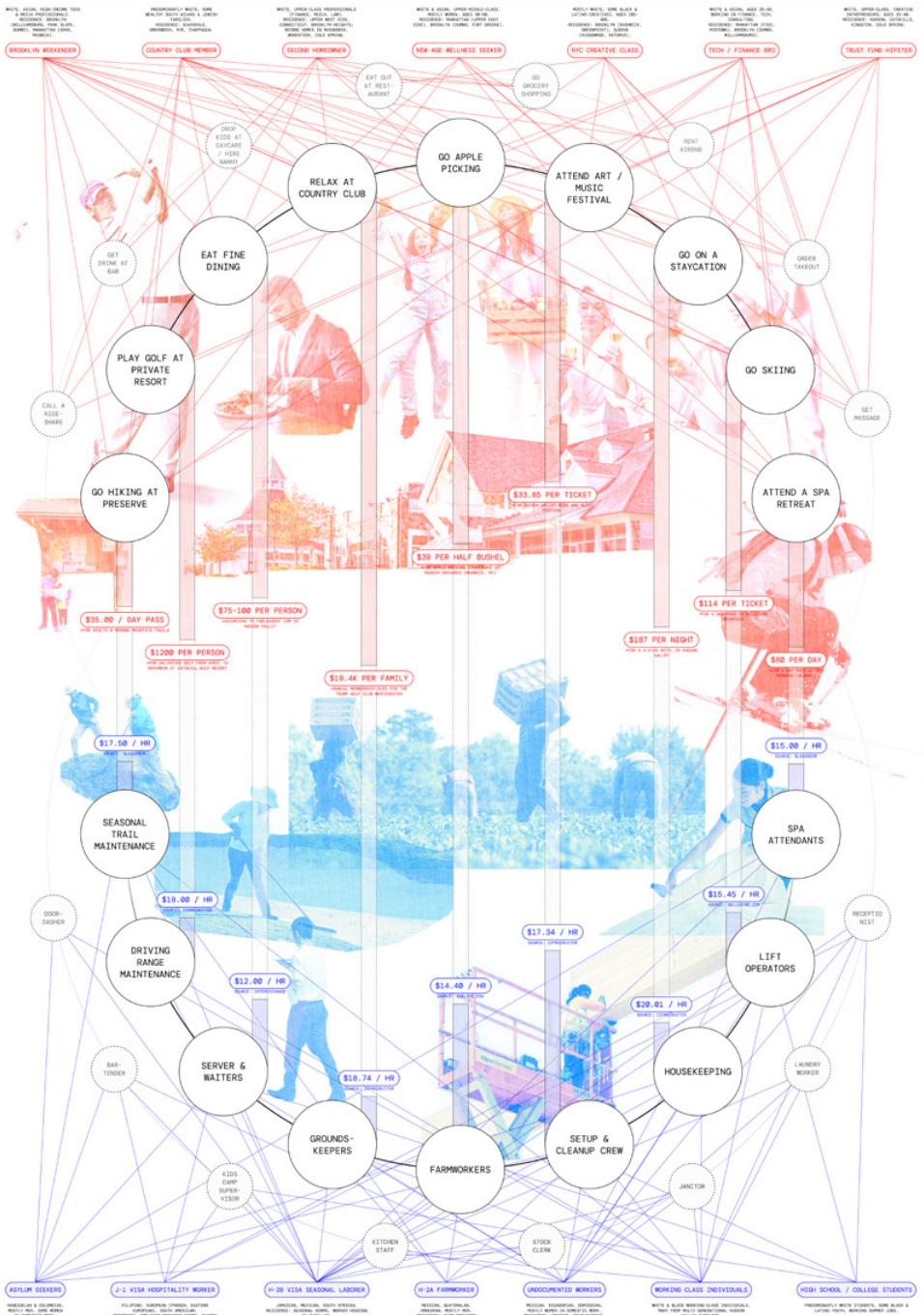






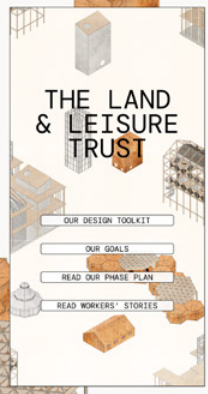






The labor network diagram maps the full actor ecosystem sustaining the country club's "sanctuary": dollar amounts and hourly wages tracing the economic gradient hidden beneath the experience of escape.

The Land & Leisure Trust is presented as a speculative website: a public-facing instrument through which the site's restructuring is proposed, phased, and explained through the voices of the workers who actually maintain it.

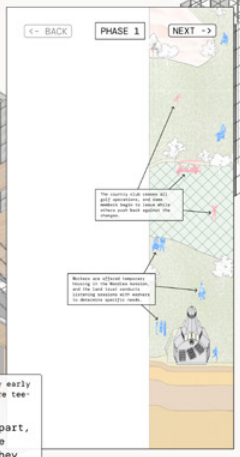


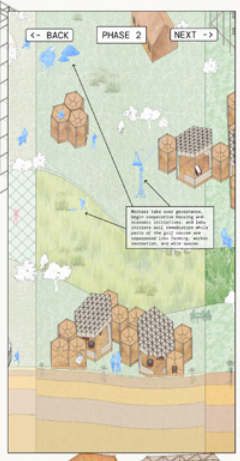
I once worked with a younger girl who had previously been employed by a country club, she said the worst part was the older men objectifying her.

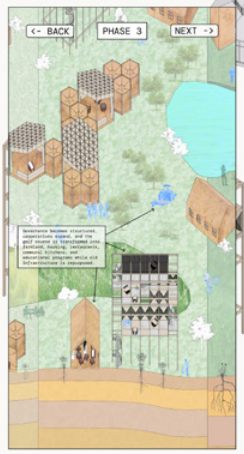
You need to 'fly under the radar,' so if you go to the restaurant don't make a stink about anything, be extra careful on the course, etc.

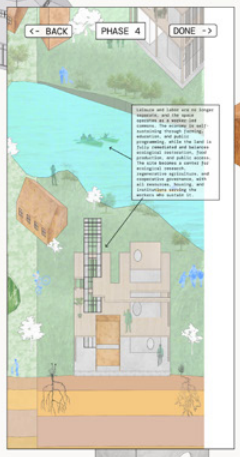
I did for a year and a half. Minimum wage even though owned and operated by millionaires, talked to like shit, treated like shit, had to be around useless, clueless rich twats all day. Never again.

I'll say if you can't be fake and act super polite you'll never make it. The my pleasure, may I offer you, how can I be of assistance bogus is expected. Smile every moment









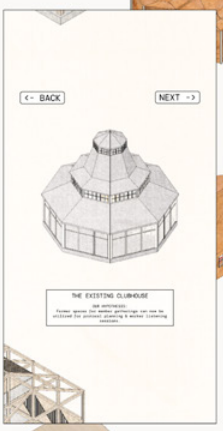
"Mostly yt employees and those that weren't did sub level stuff, like landscaping or cooking. Only yt men and women, majority women in terms of serving food and drinks. Yt men caddies and valets."

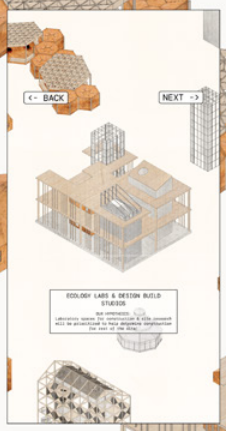
We started the day early to finish up before tee-off.

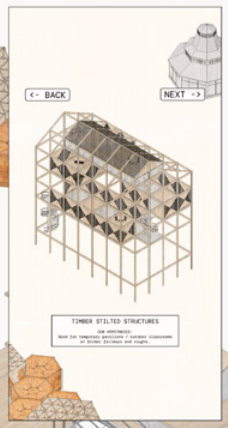
For the most part, we ignored the golfers and they ignored us…

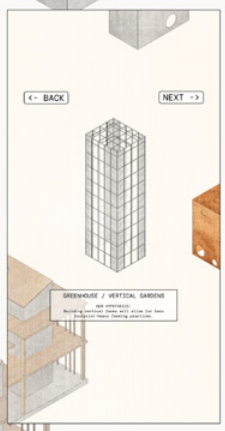
It was hard work and I'm sure the pay wasn't terrific, but I never felt exploited or poorly treated.

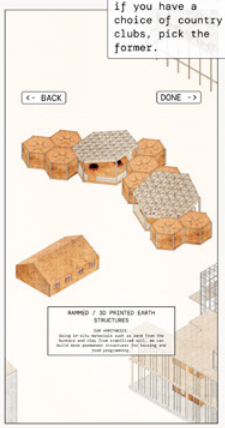
generally speaking old (family) money are way more chill than the newly rich - they have nothing to prove. if you have a choice of country clubs, pick the former.











Fairways and manicured terrain are rewritten as shared landscapes of cultivation, gathering, and ecological repair. Soil banks, communal kitchens, classroom pavilions, greenhouse towers, and slow-growing clover meadows redistribute access while rebalancing the site's maintenance cycles, foregrounding regrowth and collective participation over the performance of effortless green.

Each intervention is calibrated to a specific layer of the site's existing regime: irrigation cycles, mowing patterns, seasonal labor, public access. Rather than a singular master plan, the proposal operates as a framework for adaptation, programs that evolve alongside erosion, cultivation, and time.

Leisure is restructured as participation: planting, cooking, learning, and gathering become shared acts that redistribute both access and care. Rather than erasing the site's past as an exclusive recreational landscape, the proposal makes its systems visible and negotiable. Competing forces, human and more-than-human, mechanical and organic, private and collective, are allowed to intersect within a dynamic terrain. Machine grading coexists with hand planting; spectacle gives way to stewardship. The landscape is treated not as a finished image but as an ongoing process, a commons shaped by maintenance, labor, and seasonal change. In doing so, the project reframes the ground itself as an active civic participant rather than a passive backdrop for consumption.

BY/PRODUCT

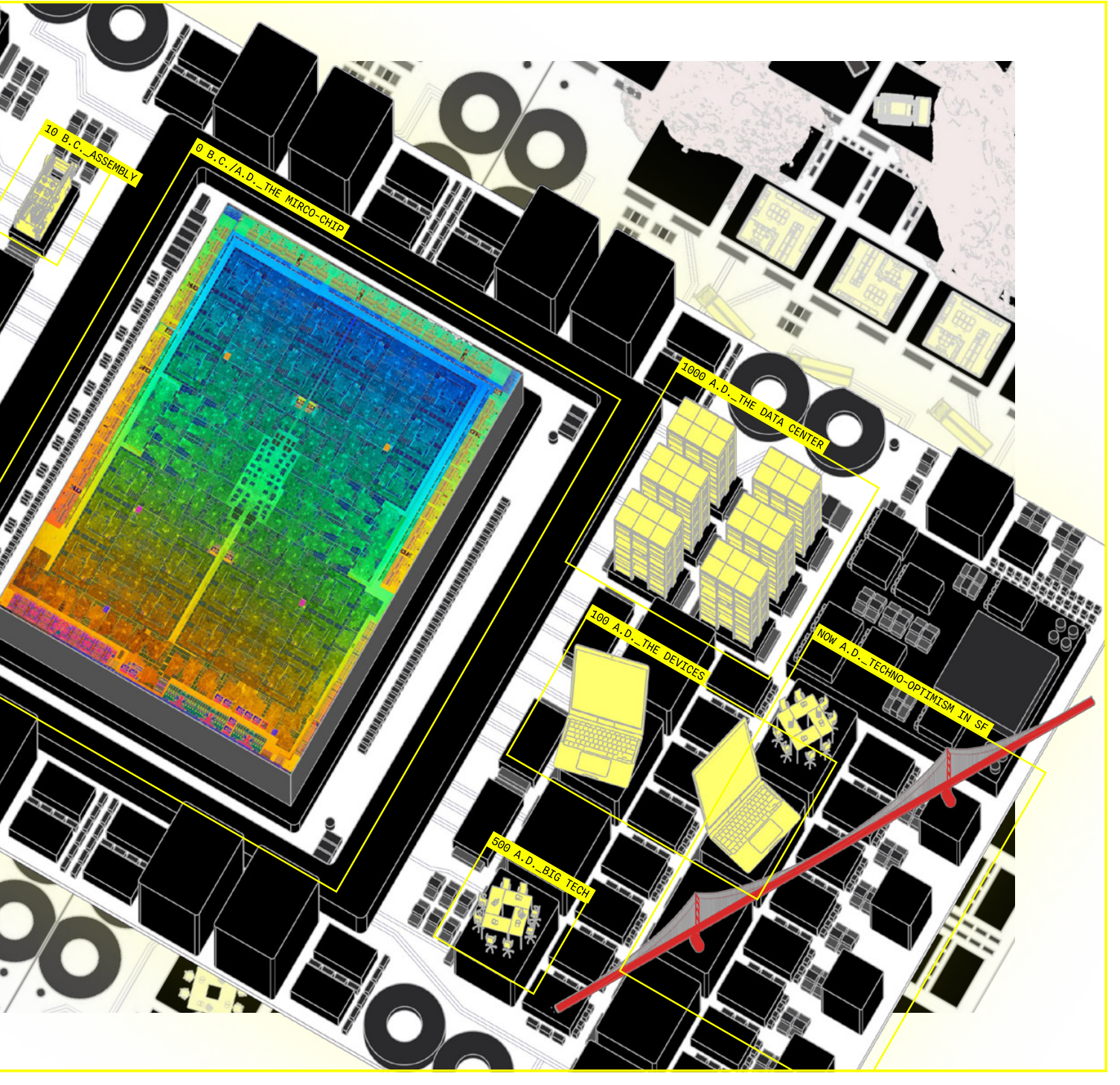
SEMESTER:
ADV VI “Design As Research”
Spring 2026

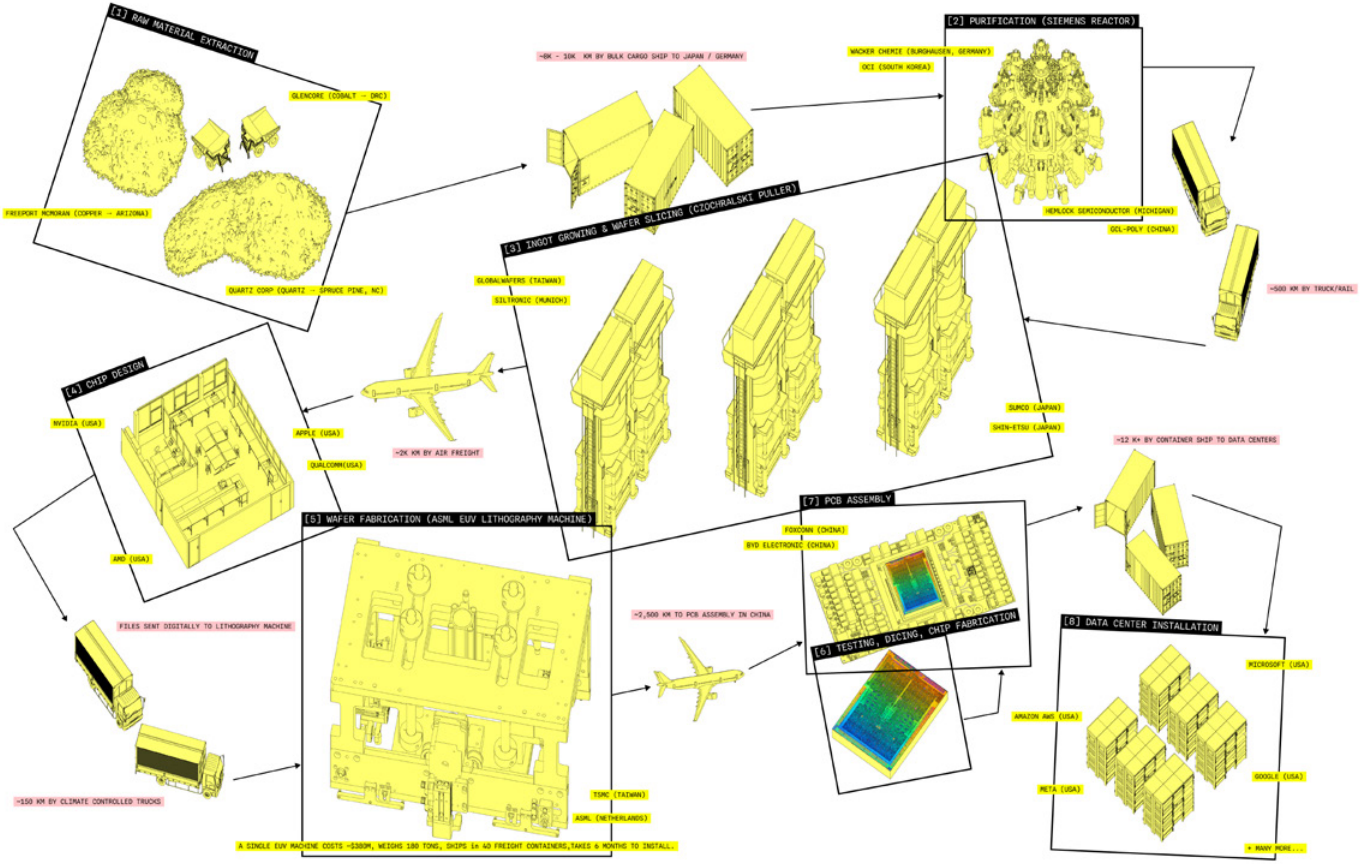
INSTRUCTOR:
Lydia Kallipoliti

Every made thing leaves a byproduct. A cut produces an offcut. A stone block requires a quarry. A microchip exploits bodily labor. The product is designed to perfection. The byproduct rarely is.

This thesis proposes a methodology for reading the value systems embedded in what we build, before they are inherited by the machines about to dictate the next century. AI is an act of archival. Whatever we feed it becomes the canon, reproduced at a scale no individual architect ever could. A building that externalizes its waste, conceals its labor, and has no plan for its own death carries a value system that will be passed down to every model trained on it.

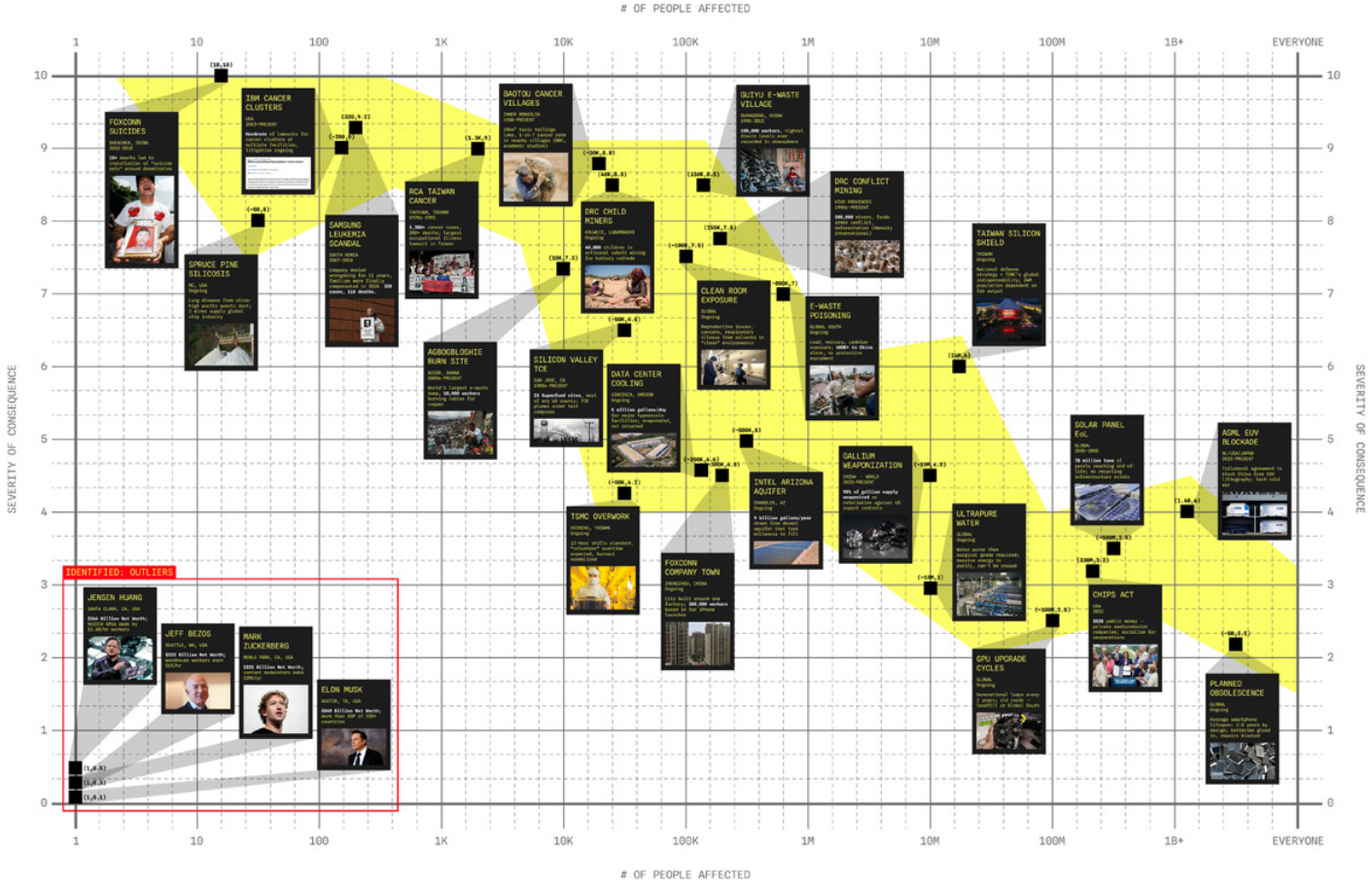
The most urgent task we have as designers is to learn how to follow a thing from origin to consequence, and ask whether its maker planned for the aftereffects. Most have not. BY/PRODUCT asks what it would look like if they had.

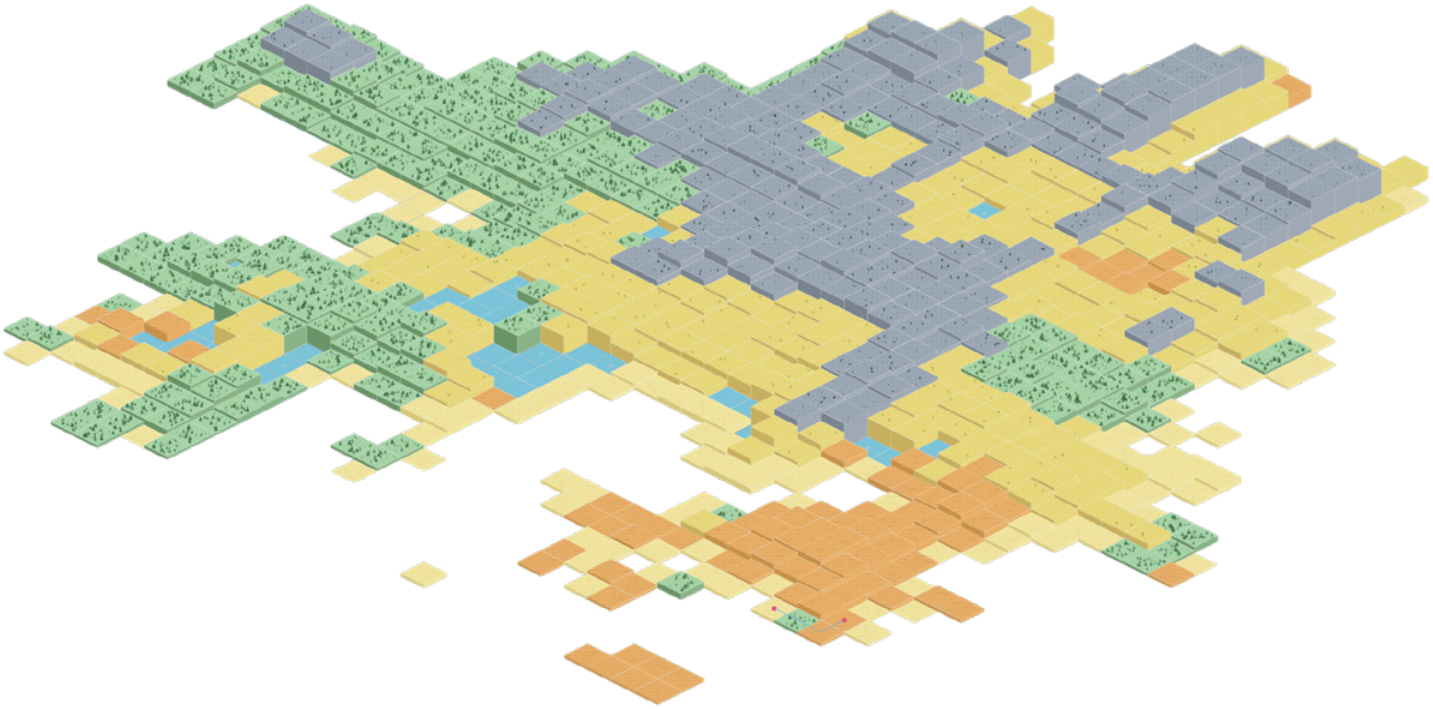

10 B.C._ASSEMBLY
0 B.C./A.D._THE MIRCO-CHIP
1000 A.D._THE DATA CENTER
100 A.D._THE DEVICES
NOW A.D._TECHNO-OPTIMISM IN SF
500 A.D._BIG TECH



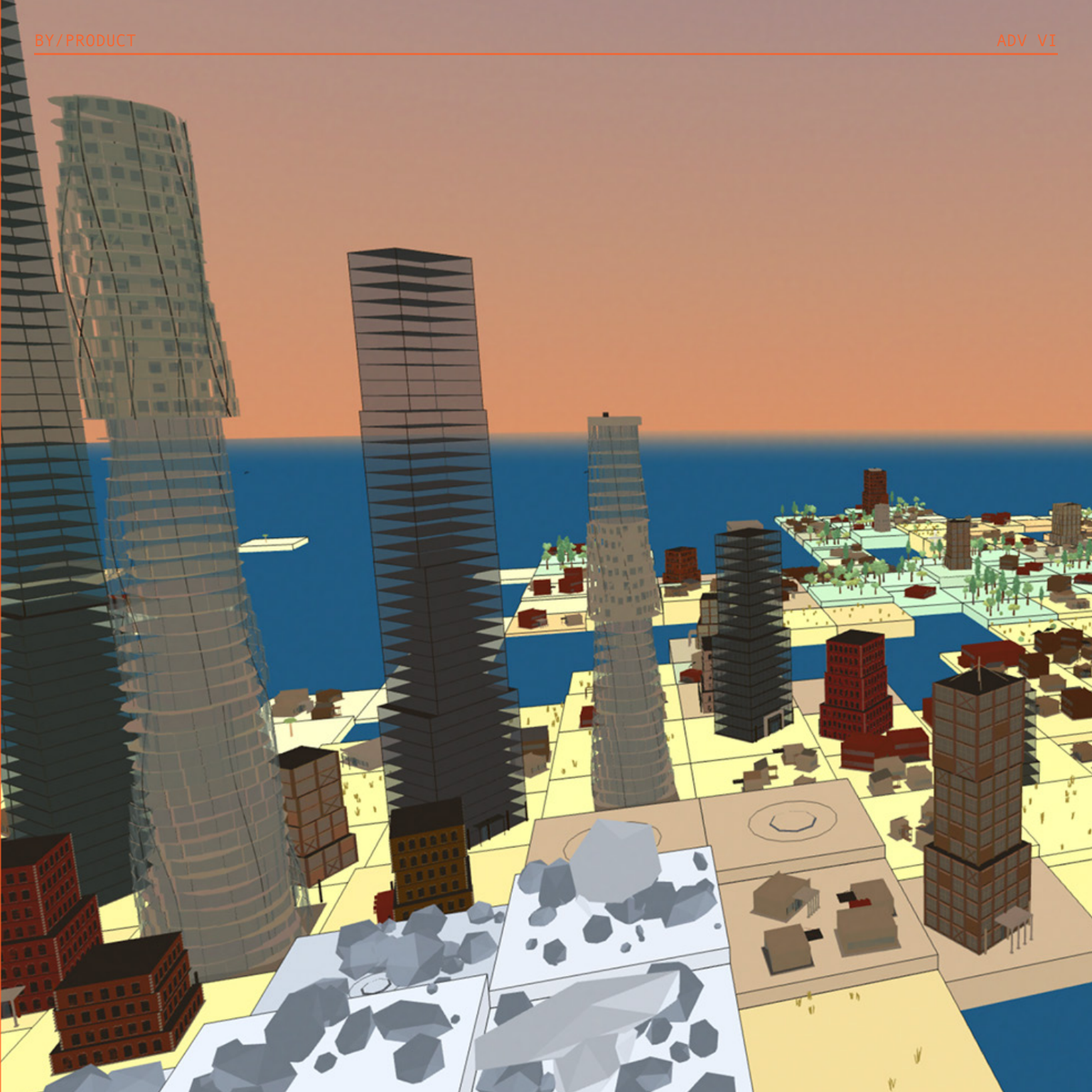
The H100 is the most deliberate object ever made. Its transistors are measured in nanometers. Nothing that comes out of it was designed at all. The supply chain ends where consequences begin (silicosis, leukemia clusters, drained aquifers, engineered obsolescence) distributed across everyone who never signed the transaction.

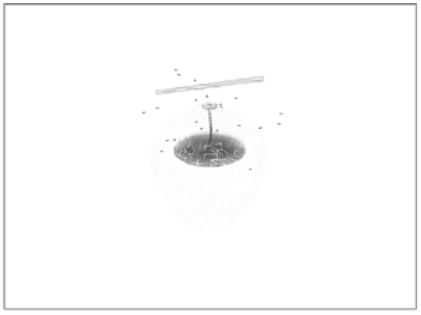
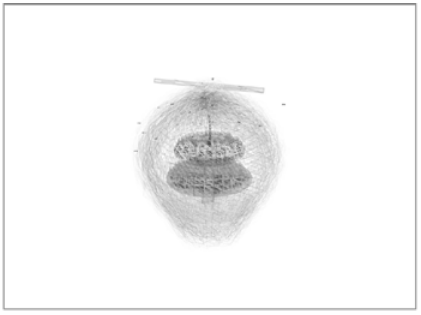
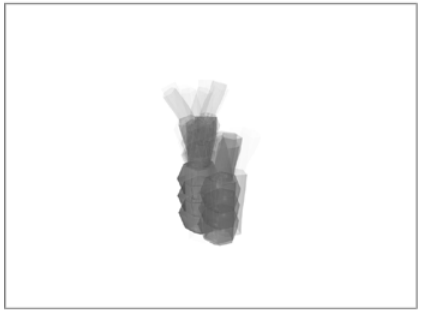
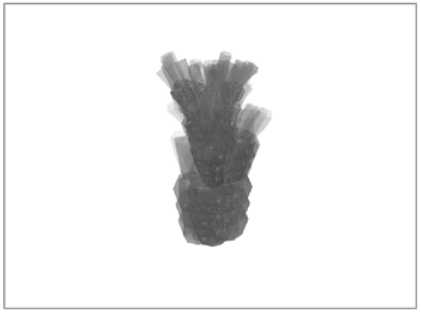
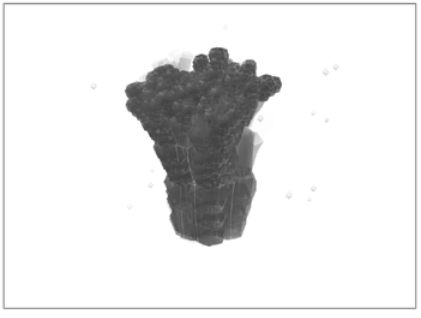
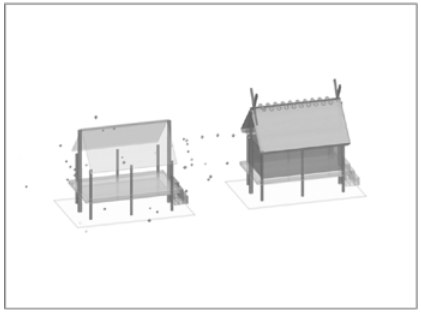
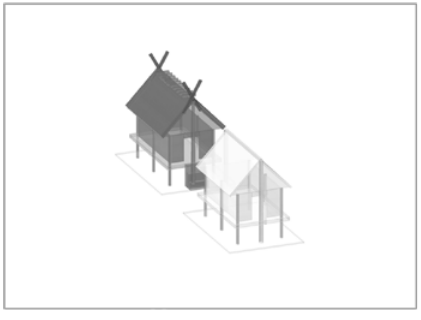
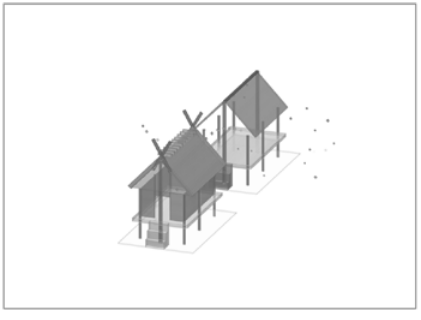
When severity is plotted against scale, the data resolves into a predictable curve. All except the outliers: men whose personal accumulation exceeds the GDP of most nations, built on labor priced at the margin. The damage is global and permanent.



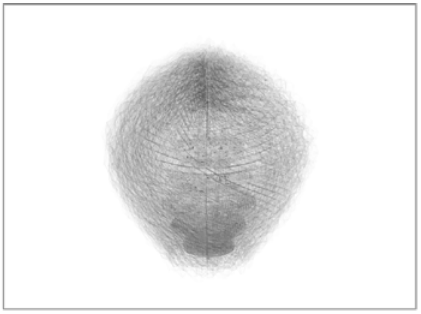
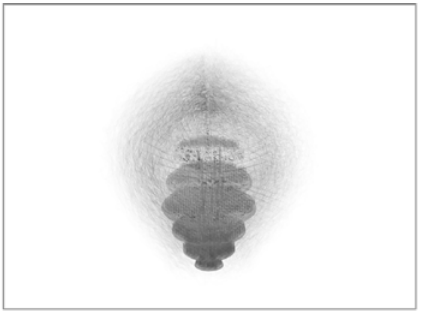
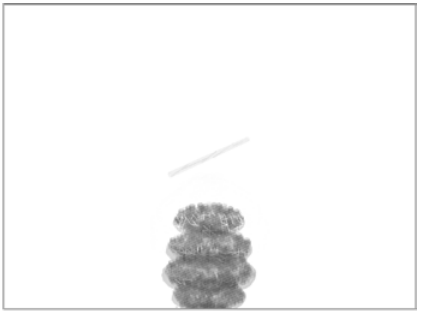


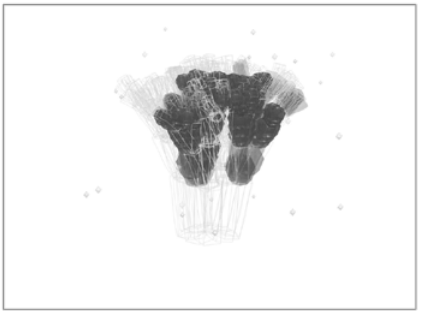
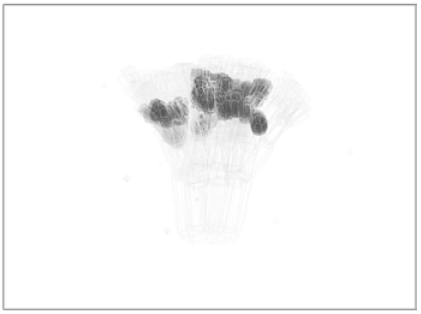
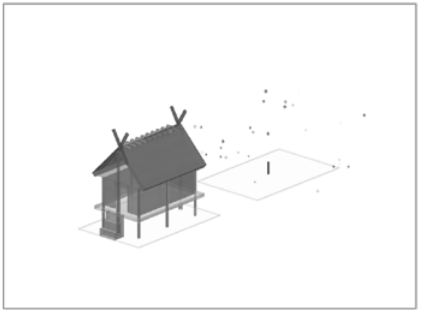
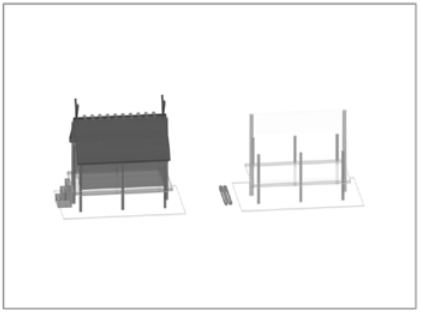
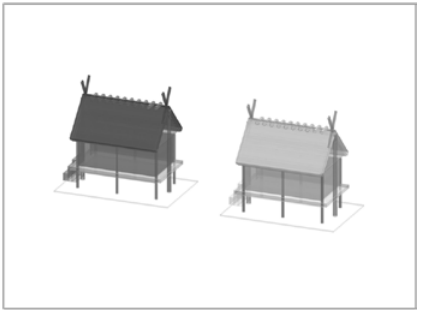
To build anything, you deplete a natural resource. Every beam requires a tree that once stood. Every foundation generates waste that must go somewhere. The island is finite. The players must constantly cope with that. [Play at offsetisland.space]



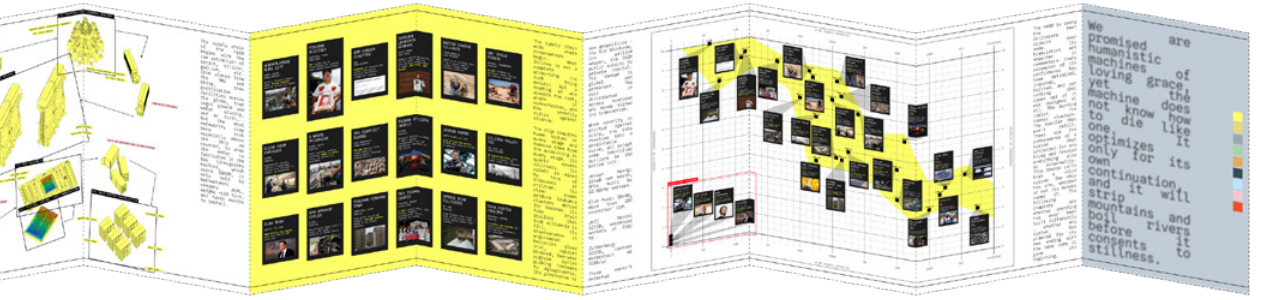









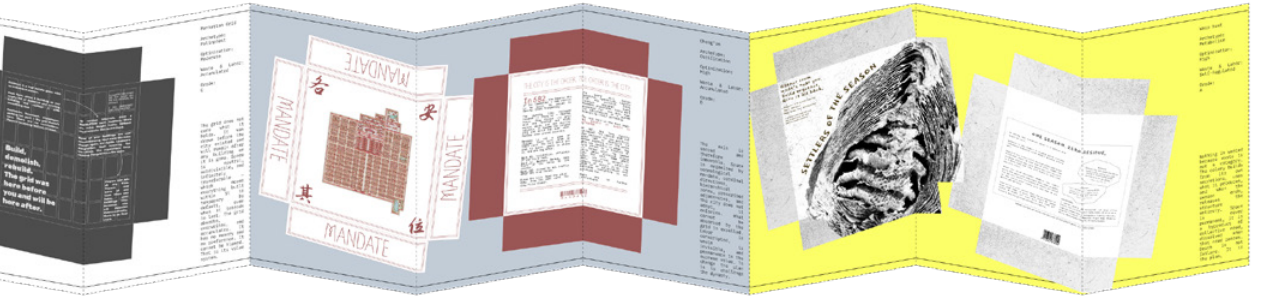
What a system does with its waste, its labor, and its death is its constitution. The wasp nest, the Ise Shrine, the coral reef. One dissolves on schedule. One rebuilds every twenty years. One leaves its dead as foundation. [Read at kelseydoubleu.github.io/constitutionreader]

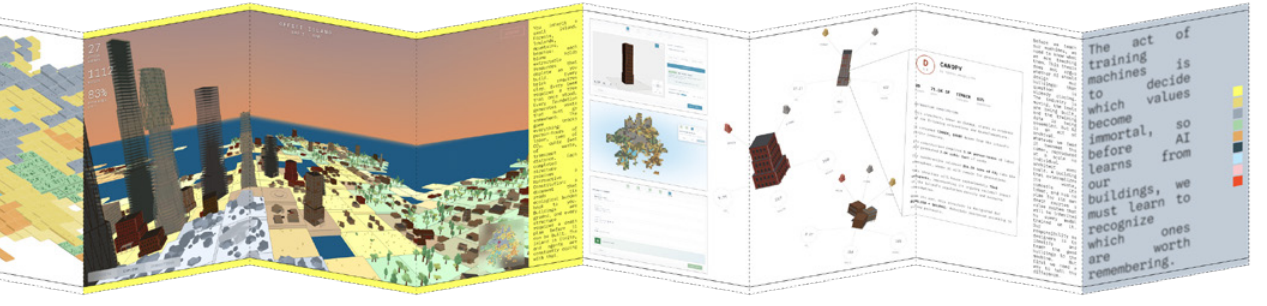






BY/PRODUCT
CHAPTER 1: IT'S THE MICROCHIP'S WORLD & WE'RE JUST LIVING IN IT
All Watched Over By Machines of Loving Grace
CHIP WAR
The Adolescence of Technology
CHAPTER 2: WHAT TYPE OF GAME DO WE BUY INTO?
YIELDS & DEFECTS
SENGU
AGRONICA
SILVER LINING
INTERLUDE: WHAT DOES A WASP NEST BELIEVE IN?
CHAPTER 3: OFFSET ISLAND


We are promised humanistic machines loving of grace yet the machine does not know how to die like one optimizes it only for its own continuation and it will strip mountains and boil rivers before it consents to stillness.


MANDATE
MANDATE
MANDATE
SETTLERS OF THE SEASON

SENGU
SENGU
GOOD HOPE


The act of training machines is to decide which values become immortal, so before AI learns from our buildings, we must learn to recognize which ones are worth remembering.

CARBON TEMPLES

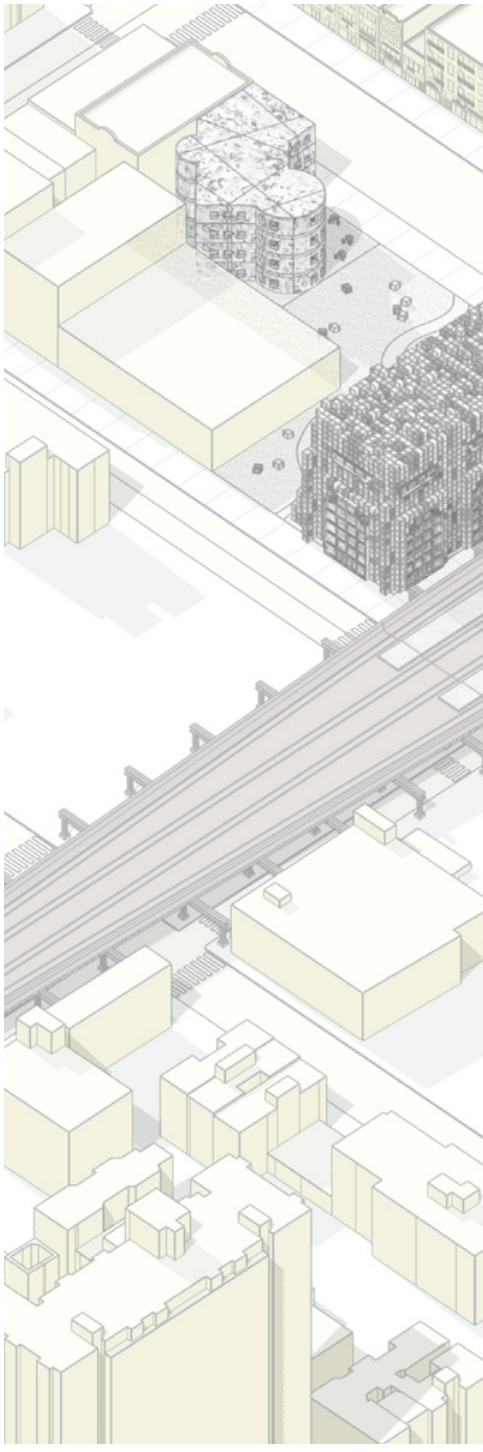
SEMESTER:
ADV V “Scaling Up”
Fall 2025

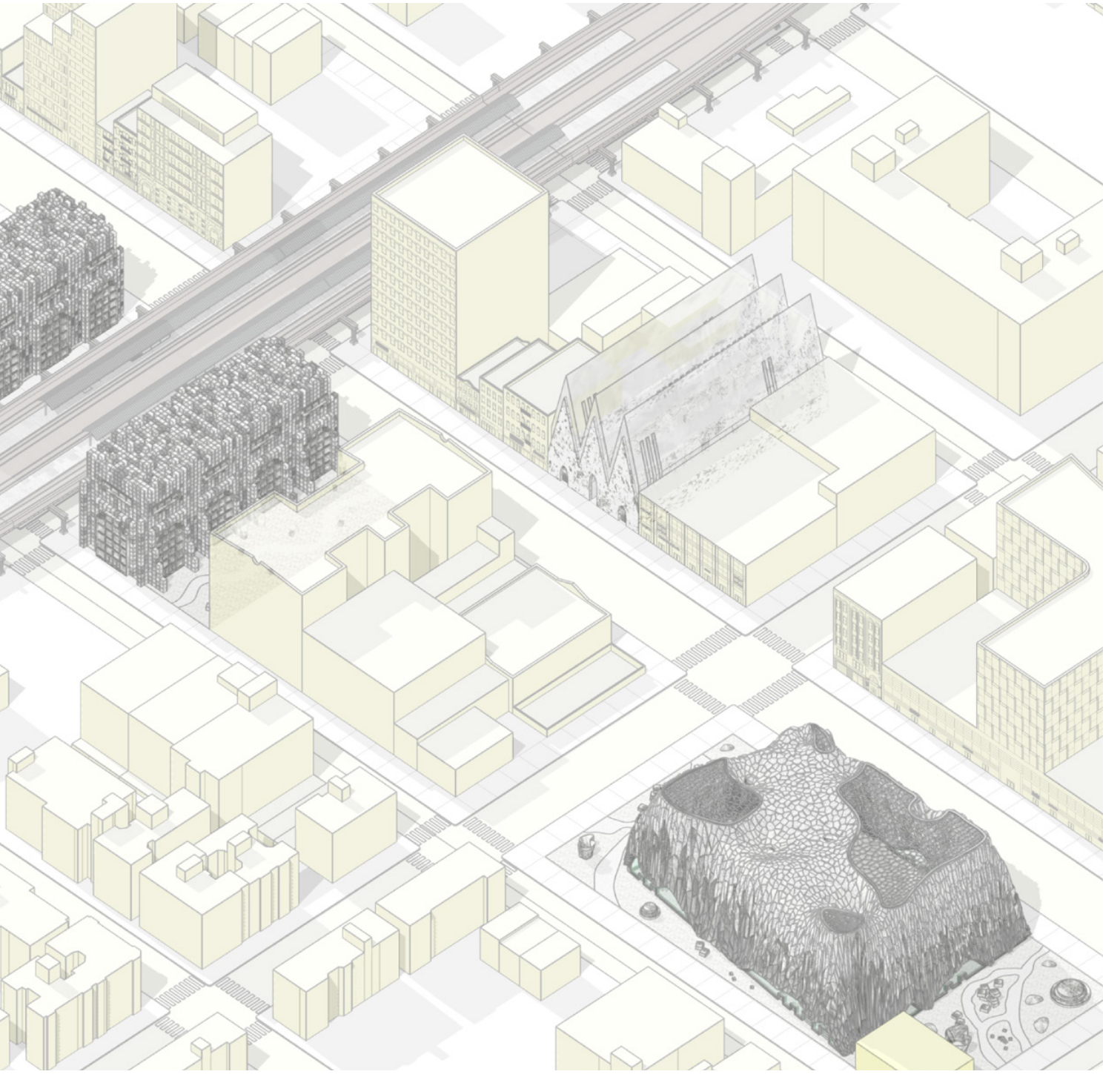
SITE:
East Harlem, NYC

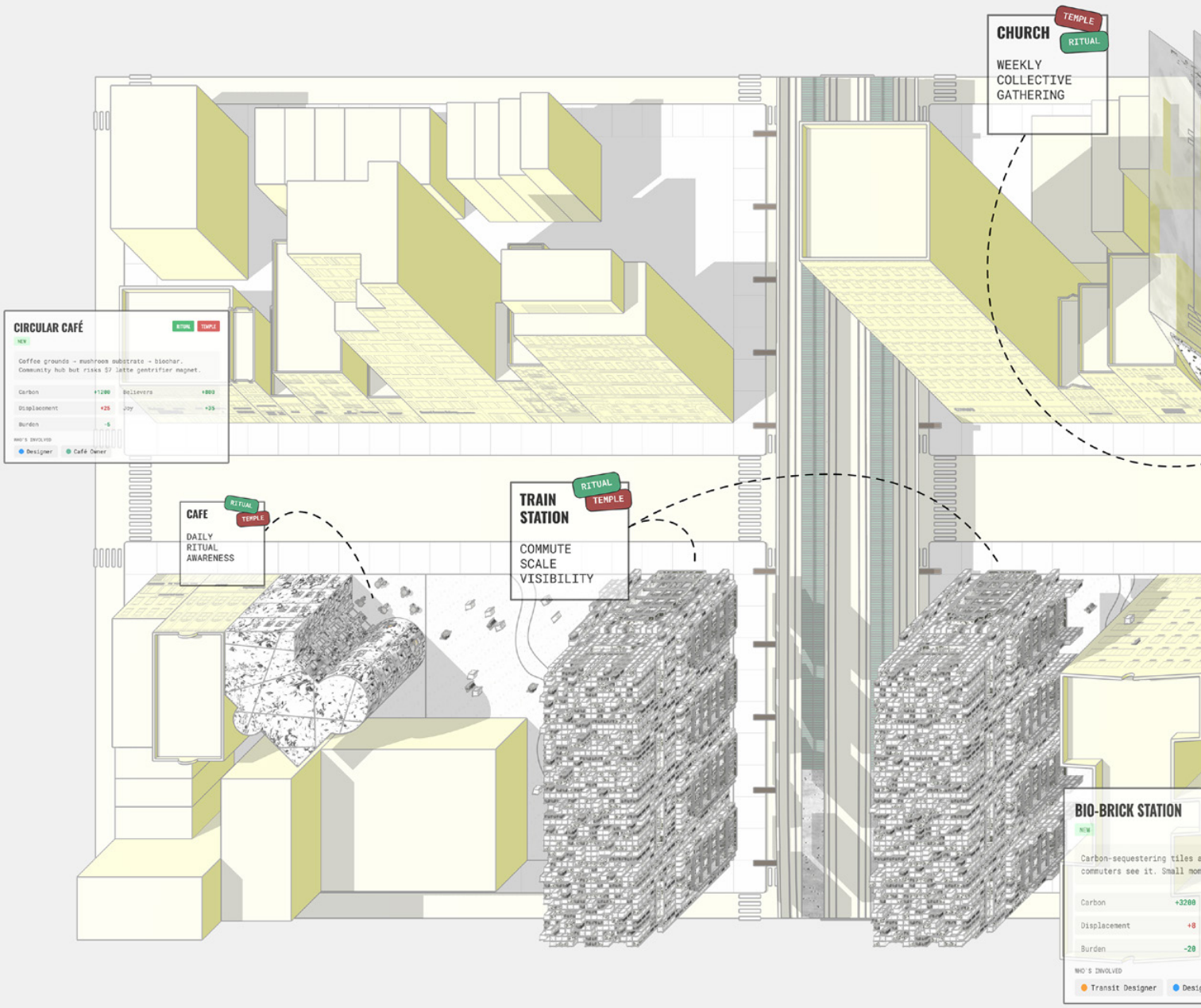
PARTNER:
Lorennah Granfors

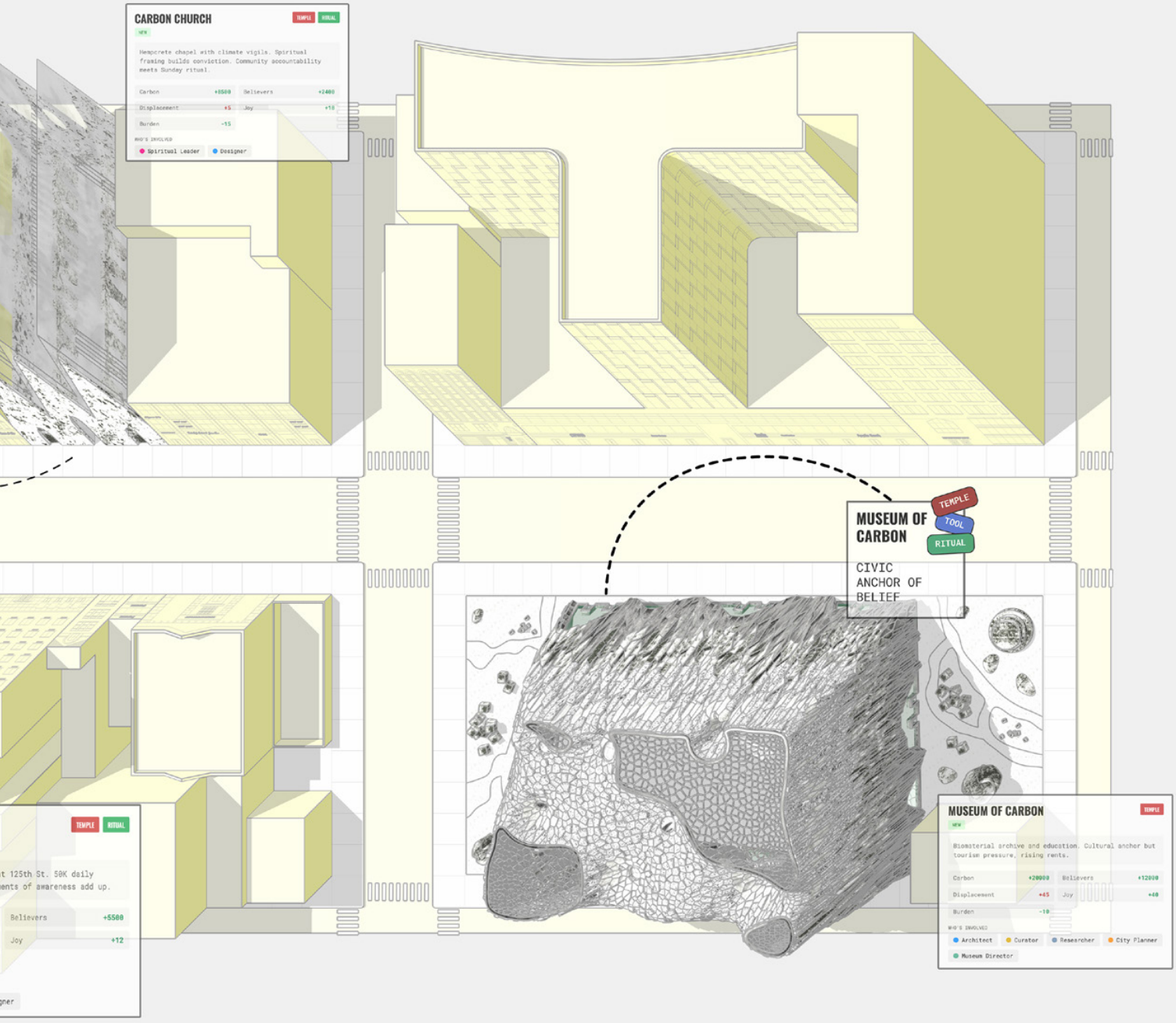
INSTRUCTOR:
David Benjamin

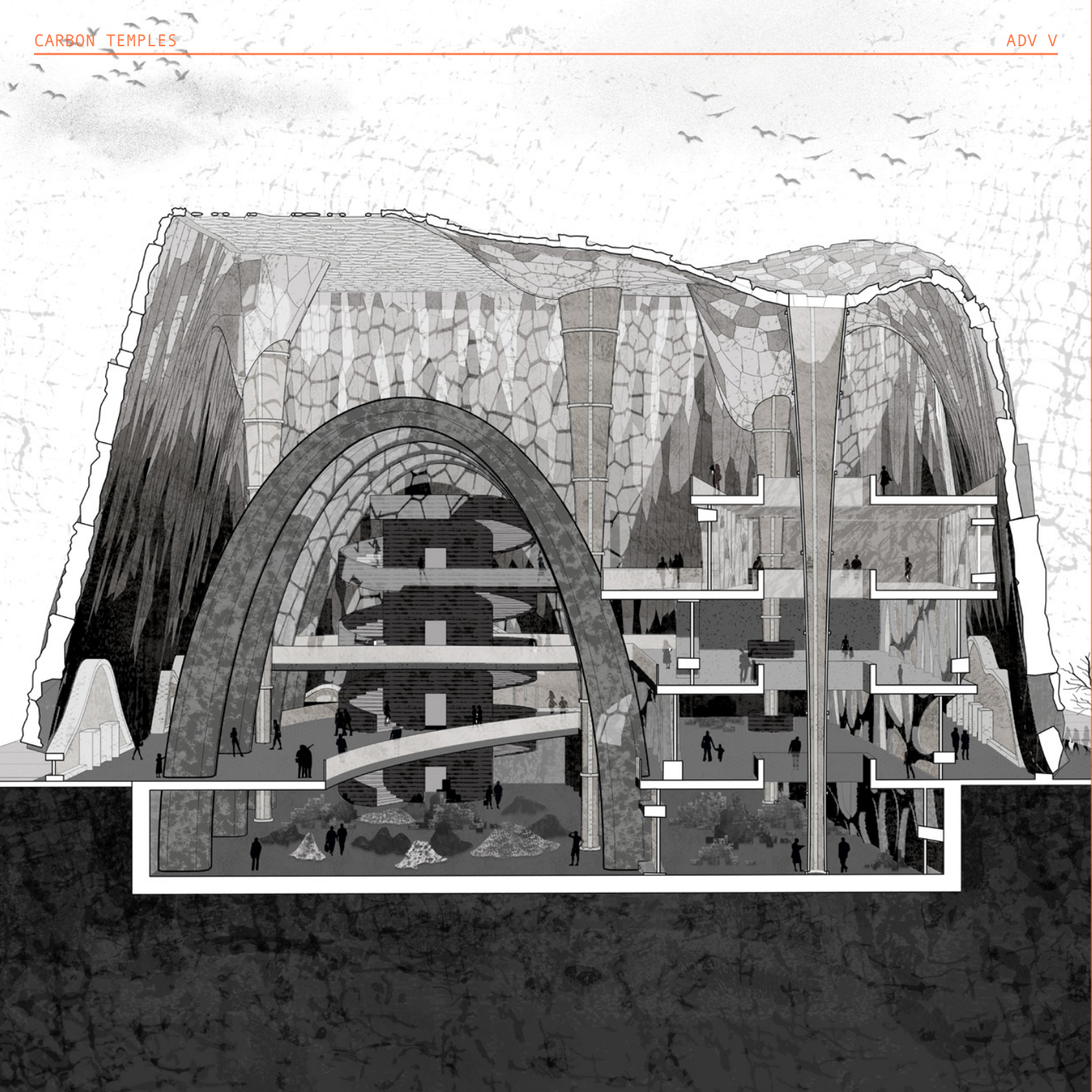
Cities sanctify consumption through storefronts, monuments, and transit infrastructure. Carbon Temples asks why carbon cannot be sanctified the same way. Climate change is a failure of attention and desire as much as systems. The project proposes a network of civic architectures that make sequestration visible, participatory, and desirable across the 125th Street corridor.





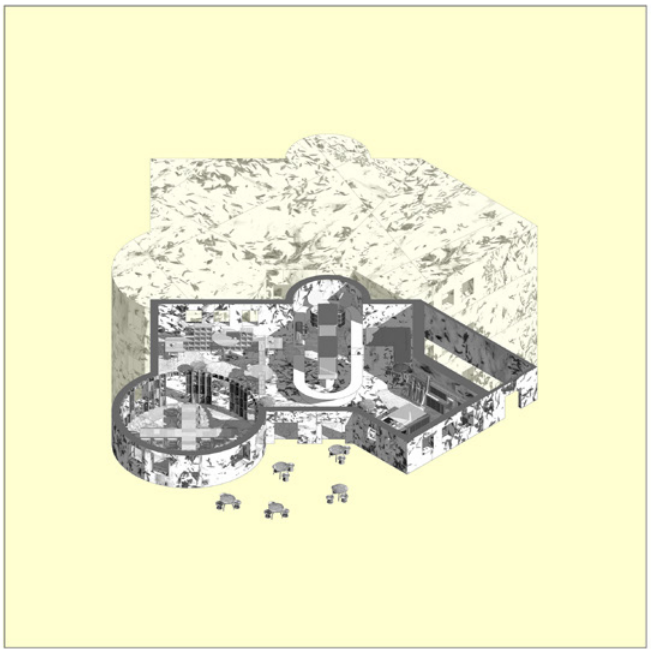

CHURCH
TEMPLE
RITUAL
WEEKLY
COLLECTIVE
GATHERING
CIRCULAR CAFÉ
RITUAL
TEMPLE
NEW
Coffee grounds → mushroom substrate → biochar.
Community hub but risks $7 latte gentrifier magnet.
Carbon +1200
Displacement +25
Burden -5
Believers +800
Joy +35
WHO'S INVOLVED
Designer
Café Owner
CAFE
RITUAL
TEMPLE
DAILY
RITUAL
AWARENESS
TRAIN
STATION
RITUAL
TEMPLE
COMMUTE
SCALE
VISIBILITY
BIO-BRICK STATION
NEW
Carbon-sequestering tiles a
commuters see it. Small mon
Carbon +3200
Displacement +8
Burden -20
WHO'S INVOLVED
Transit Designer
Desig

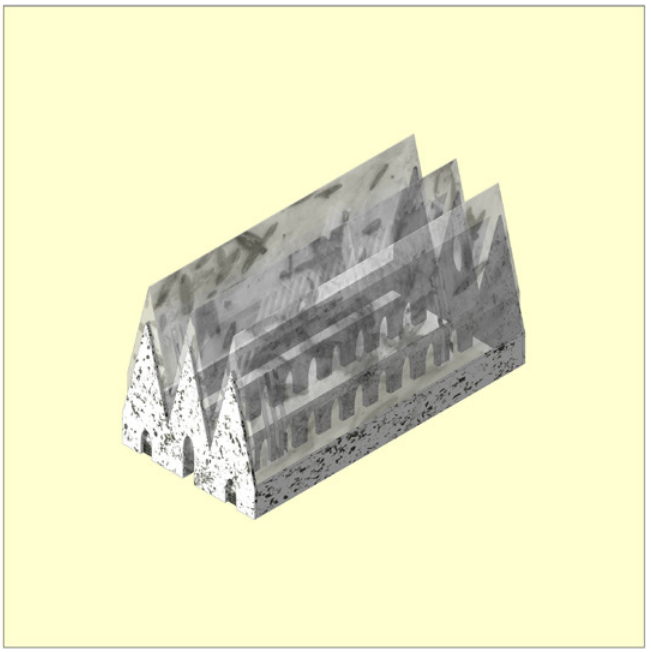

CARBON CHURCH
TEMPLE
RITUAL
NEW
Hempcrete chapel with climate vigils. Spiritual framing builds conviction. Community accountability meets Sunday ritual.
Carbon +8500
Believers +2400
Displacement +5
Joy +10
Burden -15
WHO'S INVOLVED
Spiritual Leader
Designer
MUSEUM OF CARBON
TEMPLE
TOOL
RITUAL
CIVIC ANCHOR OF BELIEF
MUSEUM OF CARBON
TEMPLE
NEW
Biomaterial archive and education. Cultural anchor but tourism pressure, rising rents.
Carbon +20000
Believers +12000
Displacement +45
Joy +40
Burden -10
WHO'S INVOLVED
Architect
Curator
Researcher
City Planner
Museum Director
TEMPLE
RITUAL
t 125th St. 50K daily
ents of awareness add up.
Believers +5500
Joy +12

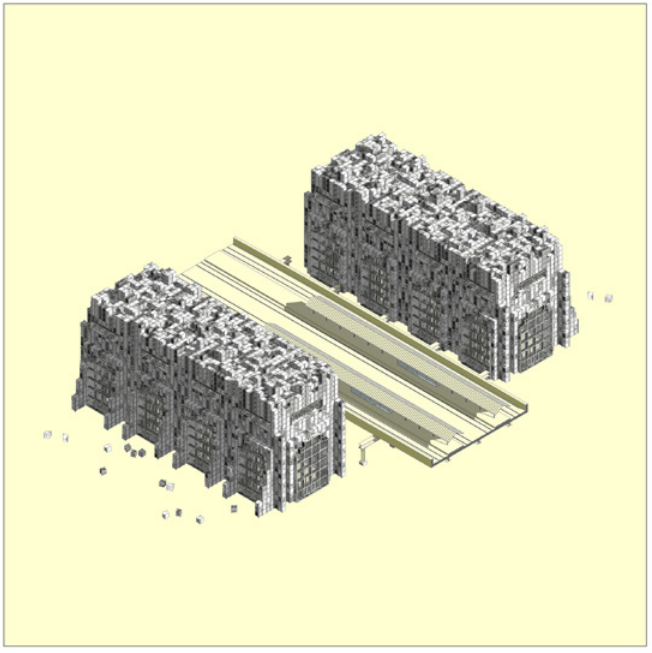


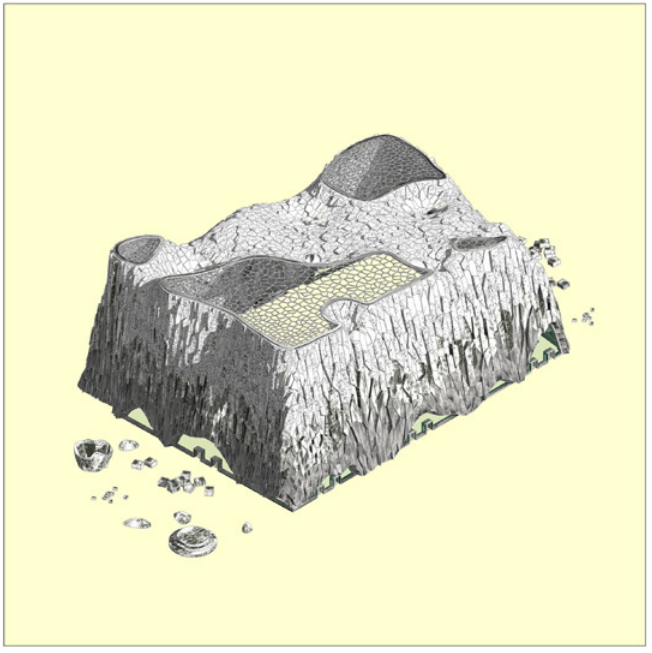
The Museum of Carbon is the culmination of a biomaterial research process begun with spent coffee grounds and straw waste. Carbon leaves a mark. The same waste that forms the structure also forms the brand and the accounting system. A space where carbon is stored, displayed, adopted, and collectively valued. Architecture as instrument for driving up carbon conviction.

Four sites of carbon conviction along the 125th Street corridor: a circular economy coffee shop, a church, a train station, and the Museum of Carbon. Each one a familiar institution re-coded as a space where sequestration is visible, participatory, and collectively valued. Carbon becomes the program.









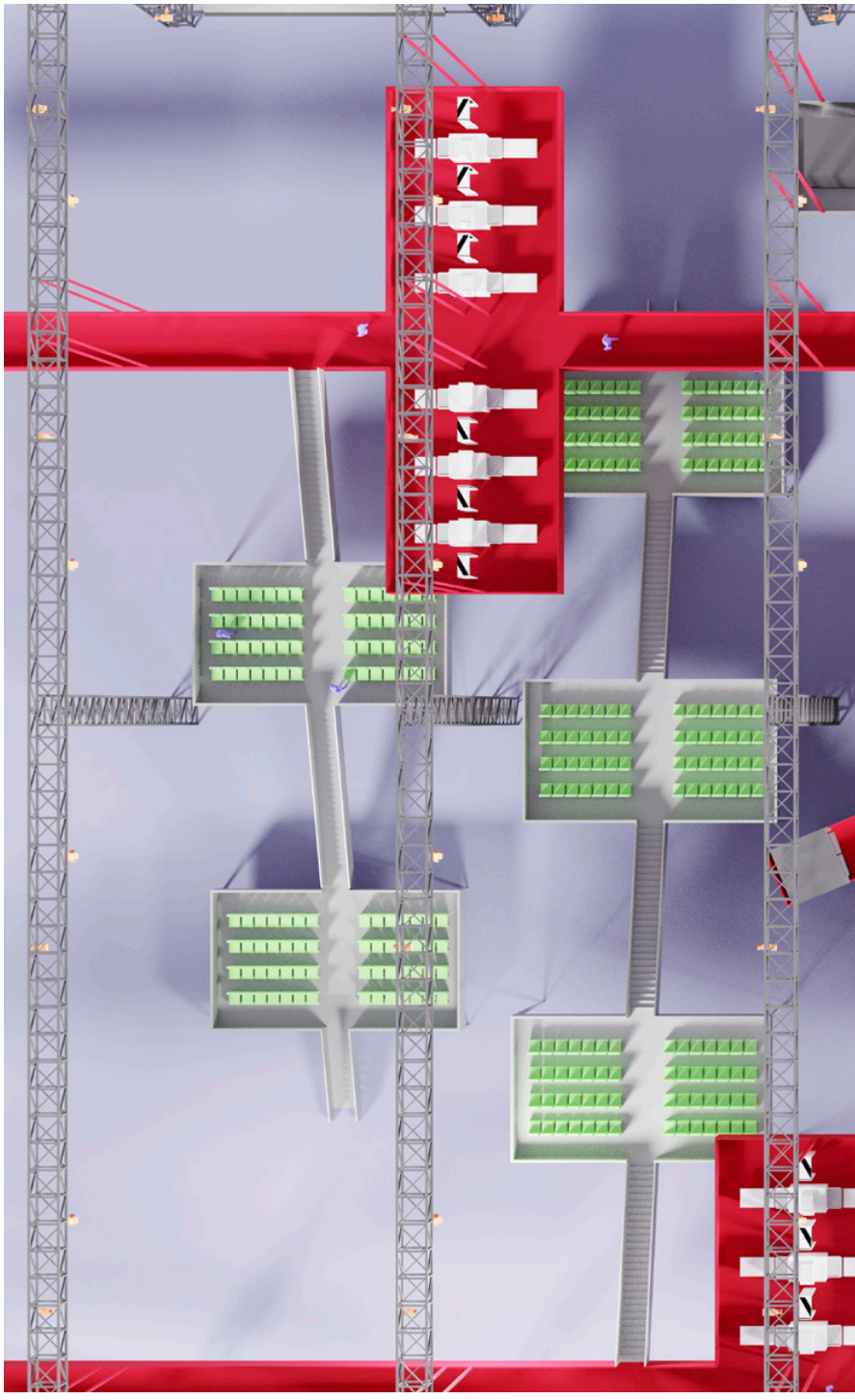
SPECTACLE & SH-216

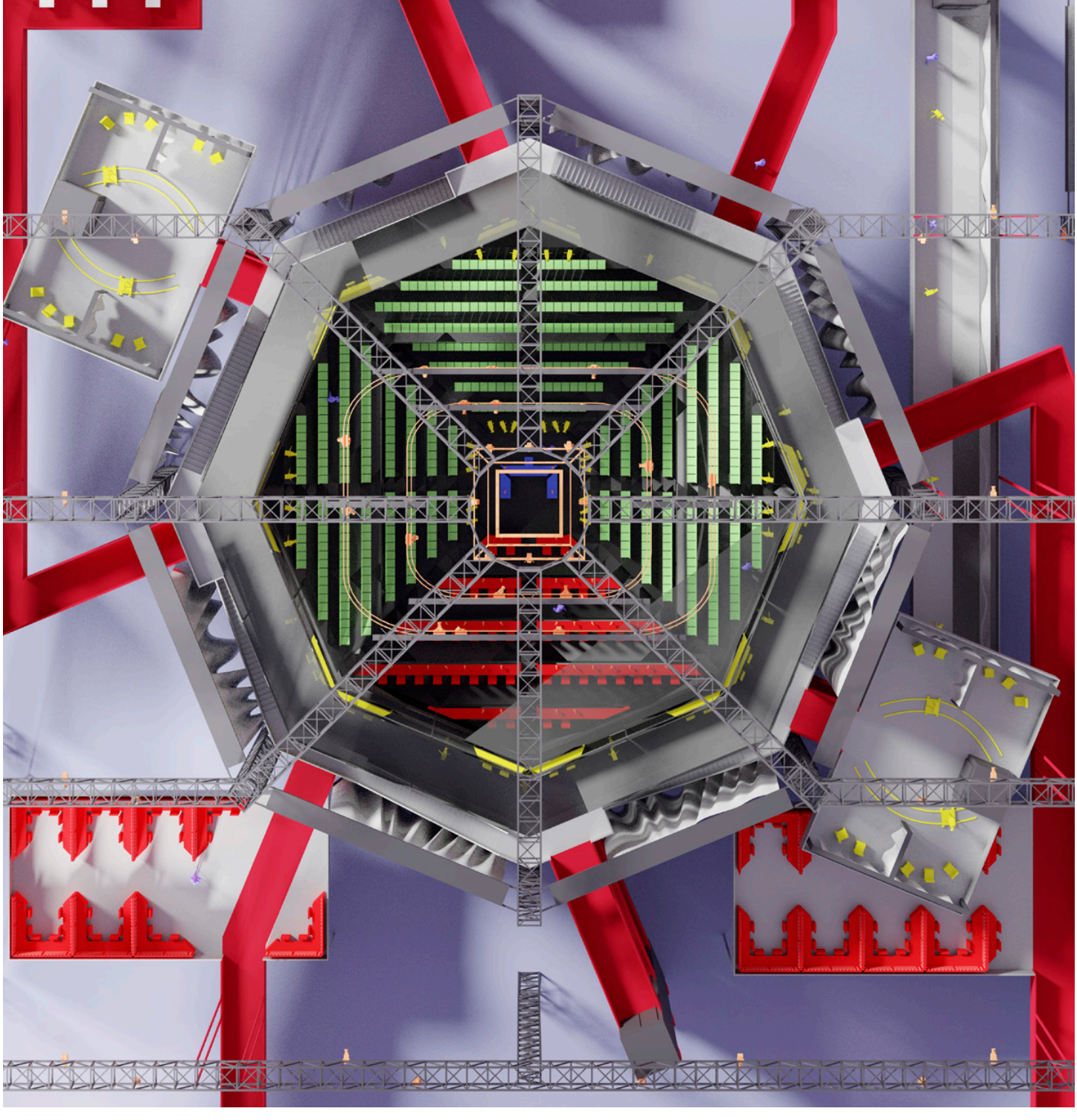
SEMESTER:
Core II “Damage Control”
Spring 2024

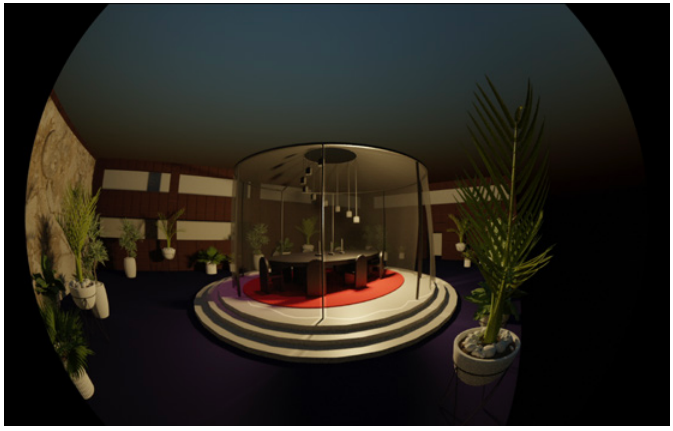
SITE:
Hart Senate Office Building
SH-216 (The Central Hearing Facility)

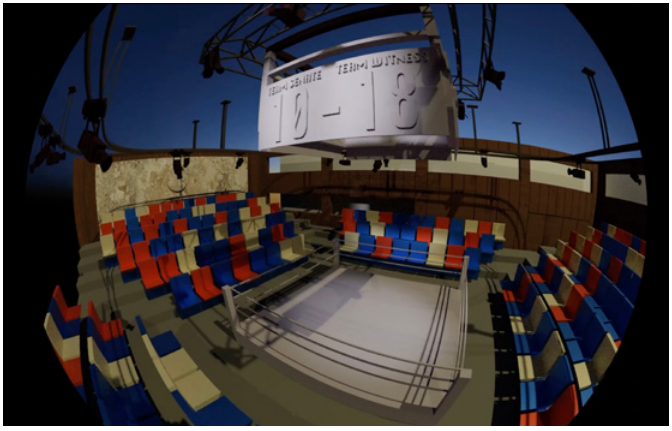
INSTRUCTOR:
Maria Alejandra Linares Trelles

The American Congressional Hearing Room is designed for democracy and transparency. It produces spectacle. Senators sit elevated above witnesses. Dark-stained wood panels and marble backdrops reinforce institutional legitimacy. National symbols shore up what the architecture already implies. As media and technology have evolved, the hearing has transformed from an intimate discussion into a large-scale production, broadcast to anyone, anywhere. The hearing room has become a stage for the government to perform justice, regardless of whether it is being carried out. This project asks how design contributes to that illusion.









MODE OF INFORMATION EXCHANGE:

CONVERSATIONAL

[1]
THE ROOM ITSELF

RADIAL	VS.	RECTANGULAR
LESS SPACE	VS.	MORE SPACE
LESS ACCESSIBLE	VS.	MORE ACCESSIBLE

[2A]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: CONGRESS

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[2B]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: PUBLIC

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[3]
PRESENCE OF PUBLIC

LESS AUDIENCE	VS.	MORE AUDIENCE
LESS PRESS	VS.	MORE PRESS

[4]
SYMBOLIC GESTURES

DIFFERENTIATING	VS.	UNIFYING
FLEXIBLE	VS.	FIXED

[5]
BUILDING MATERIAL

LESS "FORMAL"	VS.	MORE "FORMAL"

MODE OF INFORMATION EXCHANGE:

CONFRONTATIONAL

[1]
THE ROOM ITSELF

RADIAL	VS.	RECTANGULAR
LESS SPACE	VS.	MORE SPACE
LESS ACCESSIBLE	VS.	MORE ACCESSIBLE

[2A]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: CONGRESS

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[2B]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: PUBLIC

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[3]
PRESENCE OF PUBLIC

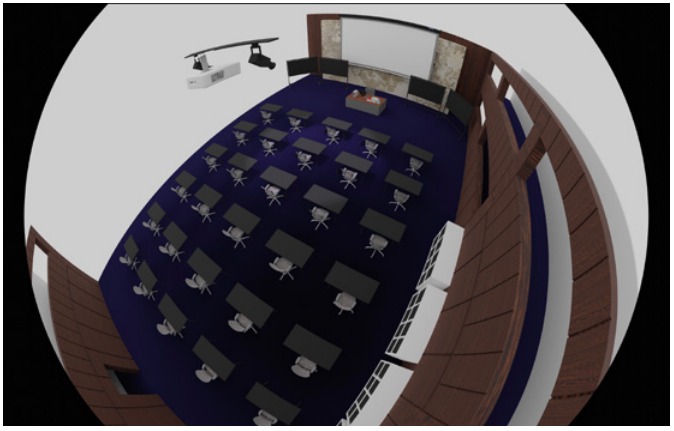
LESS AUDIENCE	VS.	MORE AUDIENCE
LESS PRESS	VS.	MORE PRESS

[4]
SYMBOLIC GESTURES

DIFFERENTIATING	VS.	UNIFYING
FLEXIBLE	VS.	FIXED

[5]
BUILDING MATERIAL

LESS "FORMAL"	VS.	MORE "FORMAL"



MODE OF INFORMATION EXCHANGE:

ROTATIONAL

[1]
THE ROOM ITSELF

RADIAL	VS.	RECTANGULAR
LESS SPACE	VS.	MORE SPACE
LESS ACCESSIBLE	VS.	MORE ACCESSIBLE

[2A]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: CONGRESS

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[2B]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: PUBLIC

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[3]
PRESENCE OF PUBLIC

LESS AUDIENCE	VS.	MORE AUDIENCE
LESS PRESS	VS.	MORE PRESS

[4]
SYMBOLIC GESTURES

DIFFERENTIATING	VS.	UNIFYING
FLEXIBLE	VS.	FIXED

[5]
BUILDING MATERIAL

LESS "FORMAL"	VS.	MORE "FORMAL"

MODE OF INFORMATION EXCHANGE:

INSTRUCTIONAL

[1]
THE ROOM ITSELF

RADIAL	VS.	RECTANGULAR
LESS SPACE	VS.	MORE SPACE
LESS ACCESSIBLE	VS.	MORE ACCESSIBLE

[2A]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: CONGRESS

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[2B]
THE SEATING CONFIGURATION: PUBLIC

UNIFORM ELEVATION	VS.	STAGGERED ELEVATION
ANGLED SEATING DIRECTION	VS.	PARALLEL SEATING DIRECTION
LESS DISTANCE TO WITNESS	VS.	MORE DISTANCE TO WITNESS

[3]
PRESENCE OF PUBLIC

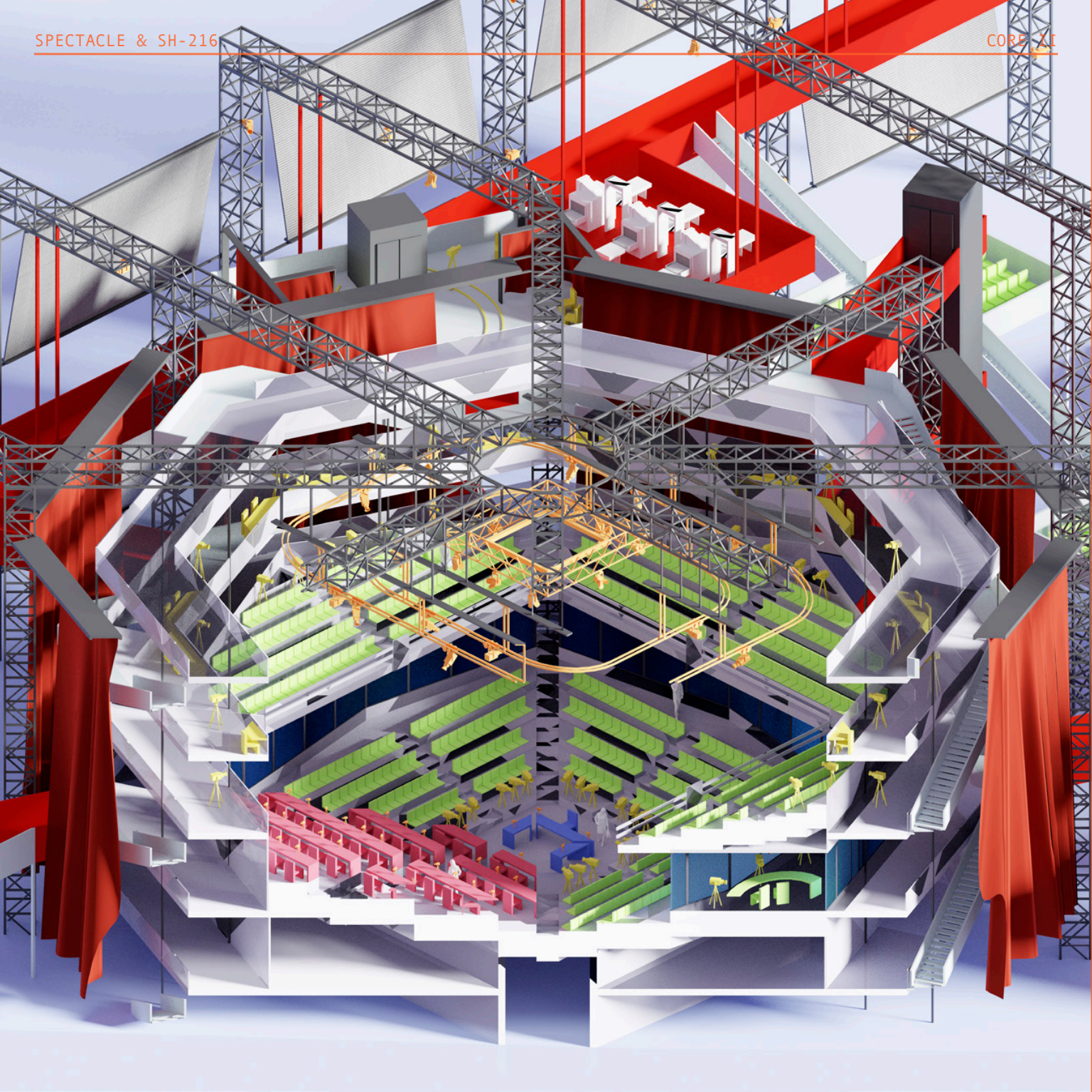
LESS AUDIENCE	VS.	MORE AUDIENCE
LESS PRESS	VS.	MORE PRESS

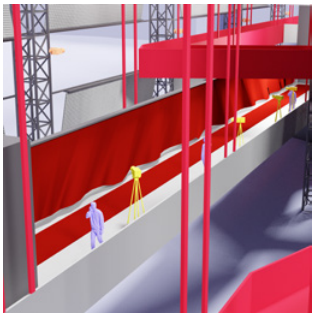
[4]
SYMBOLIC GESTURES

DIFFERENTIATING	VS.	UNIFYING
FLEXIBLE	VS.	FIXED

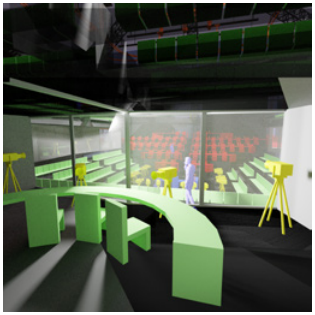
[5]
BUILDING MATERIAL

LESS "FORMAL"	VS.	MORE "FORMAL"



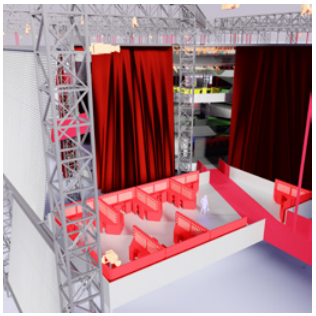


RED CARPET FOR THE WITNESSES

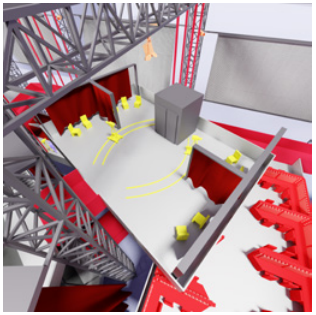


VIP COMMENTARY BOOTHS FOR PUBLIC USE

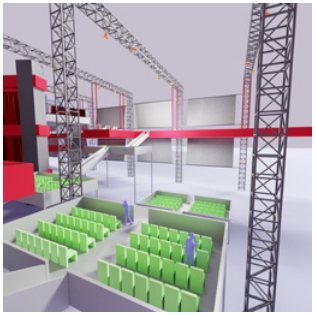
SECURITY AT ENTRANCE



“WORKROOMS” FOR CONGRESS

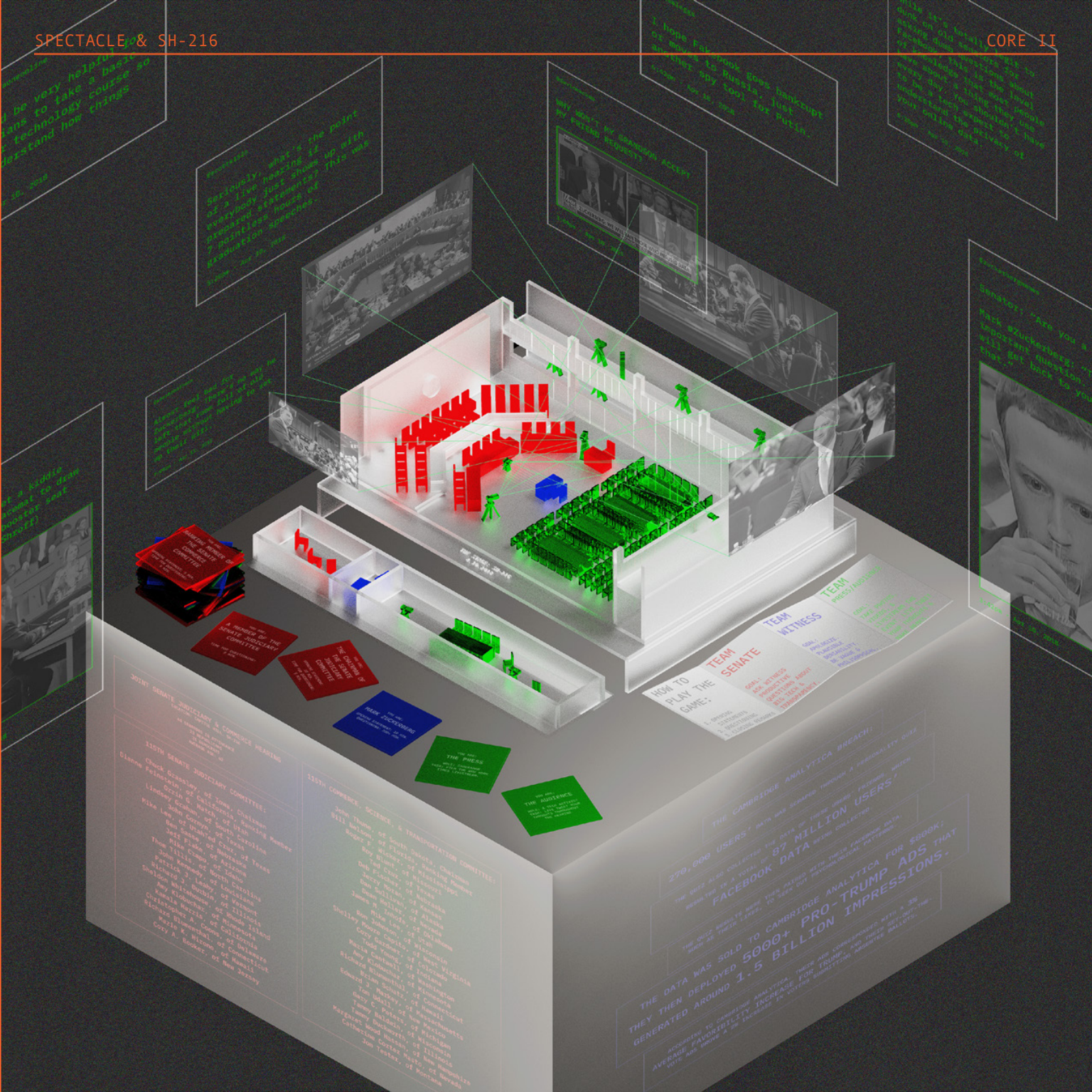


CONFESSIONALS FILMING AREA



EXTRA SEATING FOR WATCHING OUTSIDE THE HEARING FACILITY

To stress test the framework, four spatial arrangements were developed, each corresponding to a different mode of information exchange. These proto-interventions challenge what a Congressional hearing room should look like, and remind us how absurd the modern hearing has become. Rather than resist the spectacle, this proposal leans into it fully. A red carpet for the witnesses. VIP commentary booths for the public. Confessional filming areas. Extra seating outside the facility for those who couldn't get in. If the performance is already the point, the design should at least be honest about it.


HOW TO PLAY THE GAME:
TEAM SENATE
TEAM WITNESS
TEAM PRESS/AUDIENCE
THE DATA WAS SOLD TO CAMBRIDGE ANALYTICA FOR $800K;
THEY THEN DEPLOYED 5000+ PRO-TRUMP ADS THAT GENERATED AROUND 1.5 BILLION IMPRESSIONS.
FACEBOOK DATA 87 MILLION USERS?
270,000 USERS?
JOINT SENATE JUDICIARY & COMMERCE HEARING
115TH SENATE JUDICIARY COMMITTEE:
115TH COMMERCE SCIENCE, & TRANSPORTATION COMMITTEE:

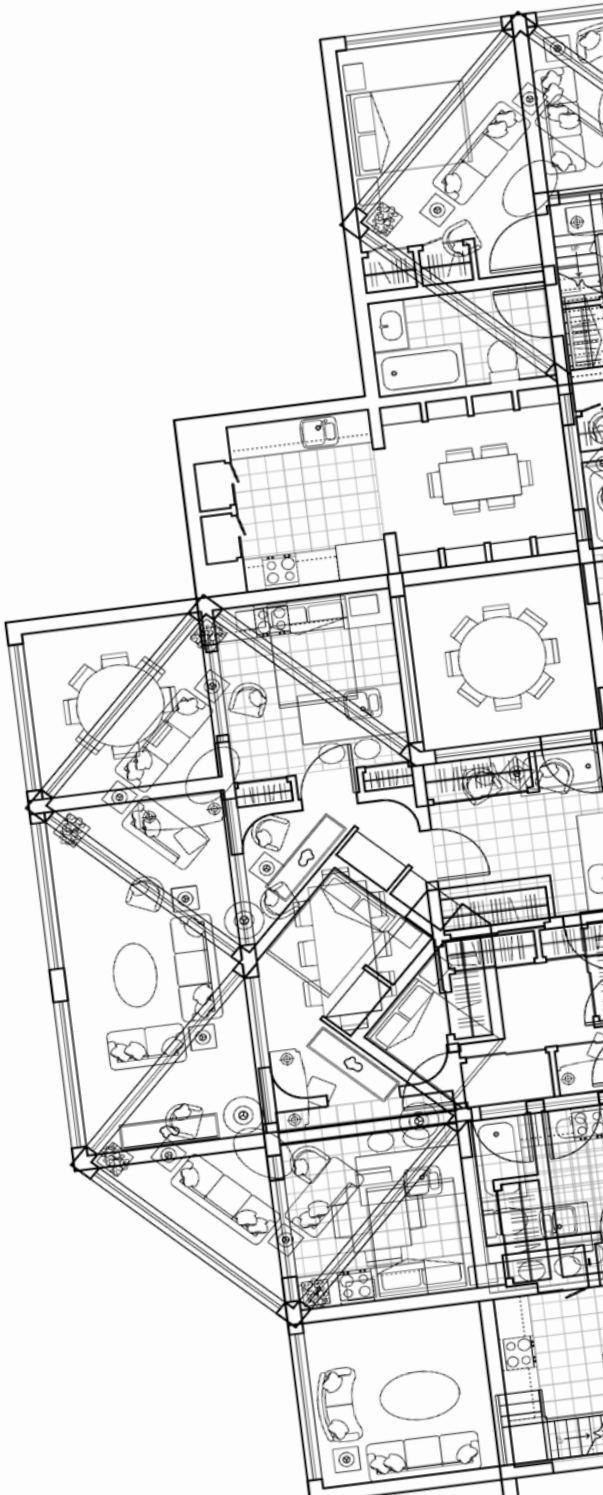
WHERE OBJECTS REST

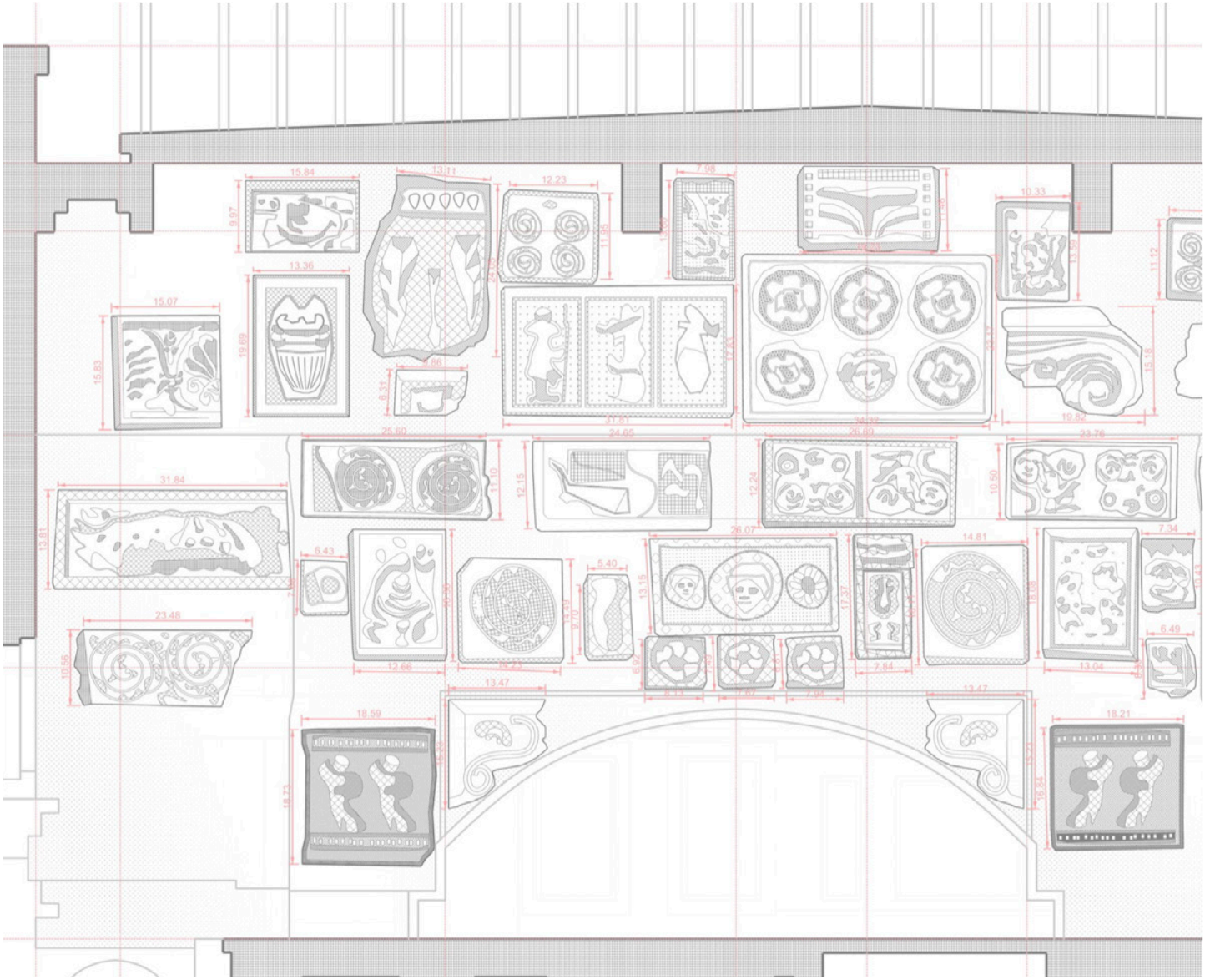
SEMESTER:
Core III “Every Thing, A Home”
Fall 2024

SITE:
454-458 W 128th St, New York, NY 10027

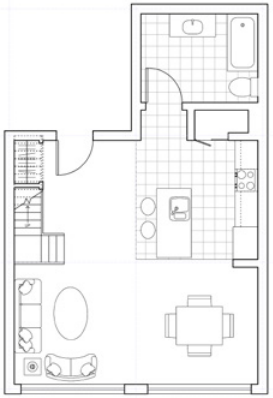
INSTRUCTOR:
Jelisa Blumberg

Housing is typically designed for people. This project proposes one designed equally for their objects. A central storage core organizes circulation while serving as a shared archive for residents’ belongings, inspired by the Metabolist movement, where the core remains constant while its surroundings evolve. Rather than treating storage as a passive function of space, the project draws from Sir John Soane’s Drawing Office, where objects are not merely housed but thoughtfully positioned, creating a sense of individuality and care in how they relate to one another. Nooks are prioritized as primary architectural elements: alcoves, recesses, and in-between zones that foster comfort, intimacy, and adaptability. Each one designed with a distinct spatial quality, whether for solitude, casual interaction, or communal living. The result is a housing model that embraces the changing nature of both residents and their belongings, transforming the way we live with objects.

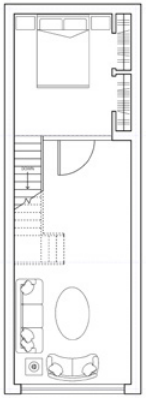




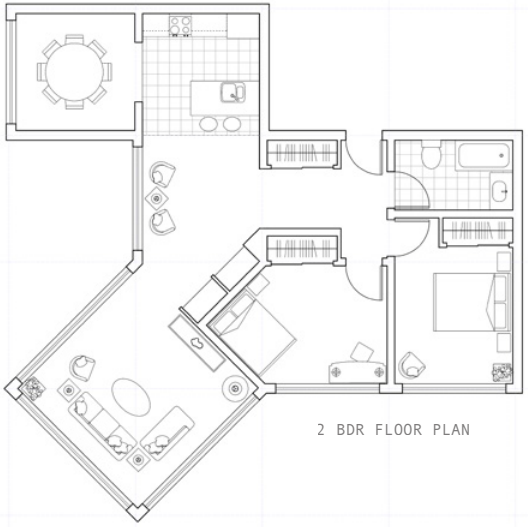
SIR JOHN SOANE'S DRAWING OFFICE



STUDIO FLOOR PLAN
(1ST FLOOR)

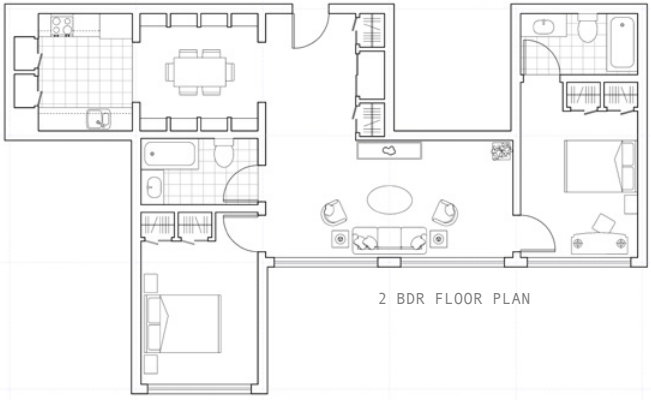


(2ND FLOOR)

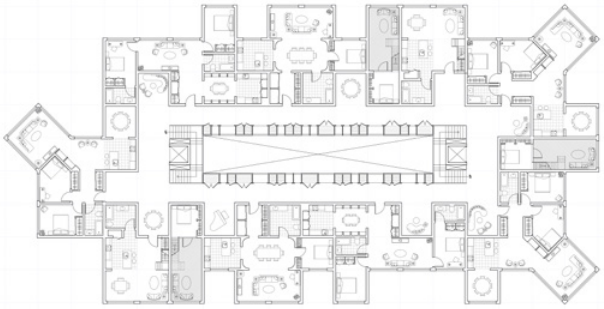


2 BDR FLOOR PLAN

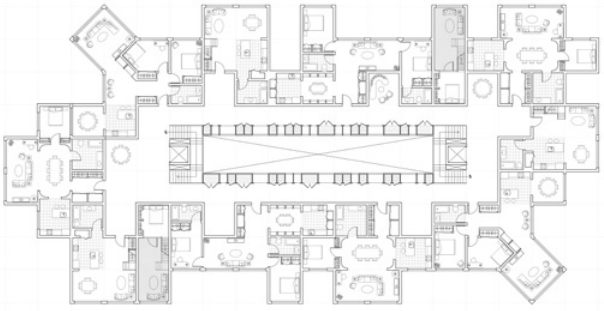
1 BDR FLOOR PLAN



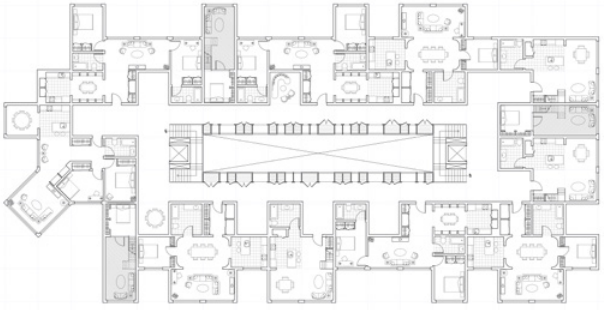
2 BDR FLOOR PLAN



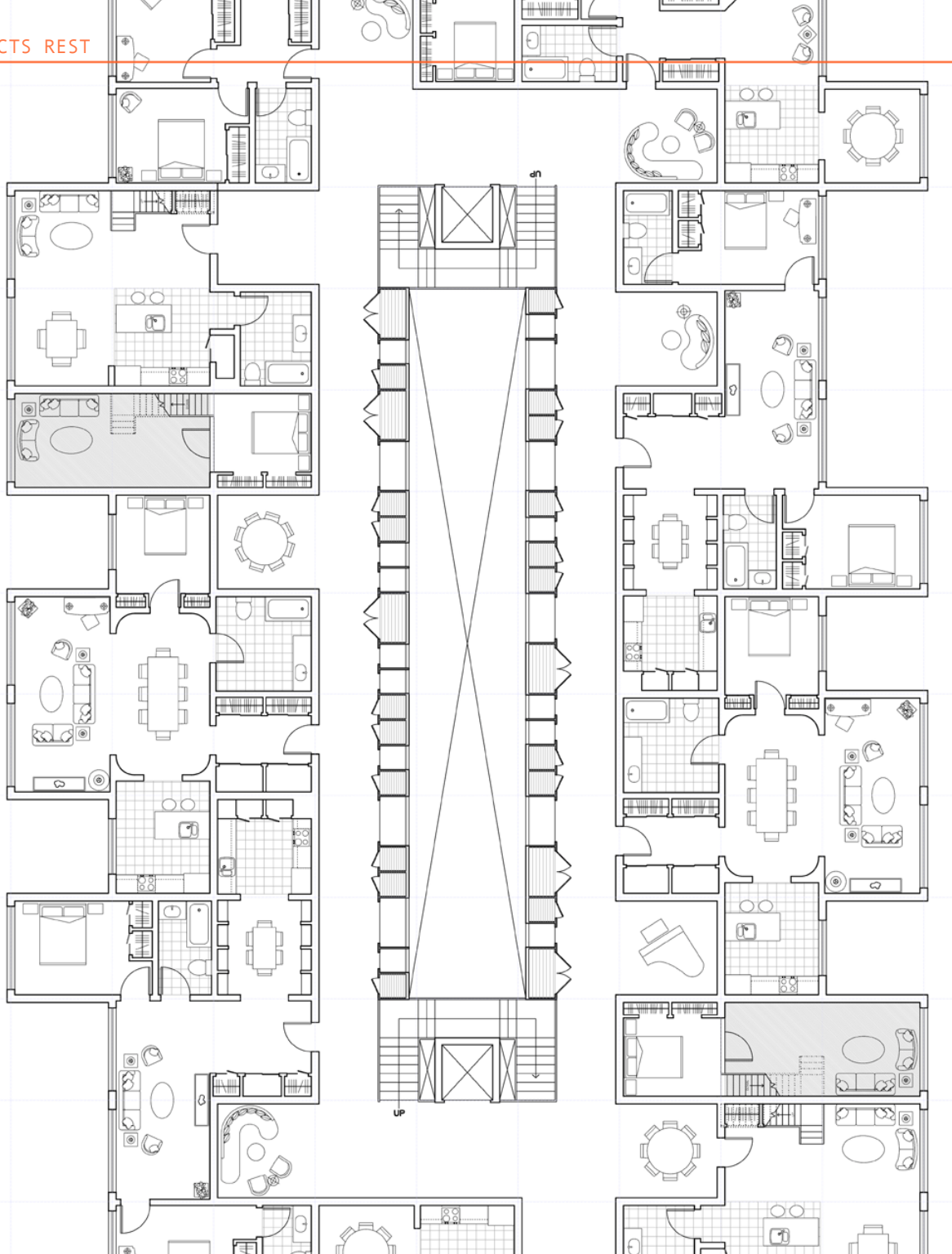
LEVEL 3 FLOOR PLAN



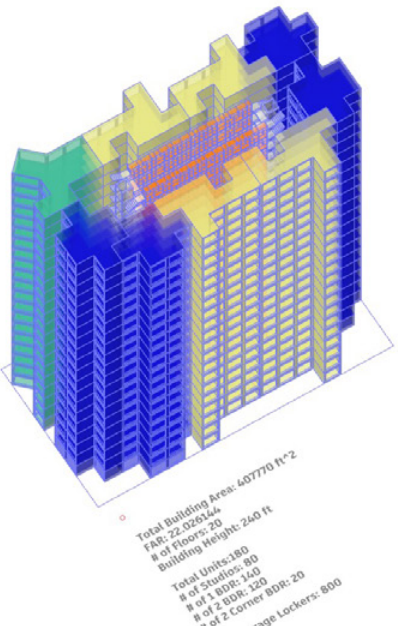
LEVEL 4 FLOOR PLAN

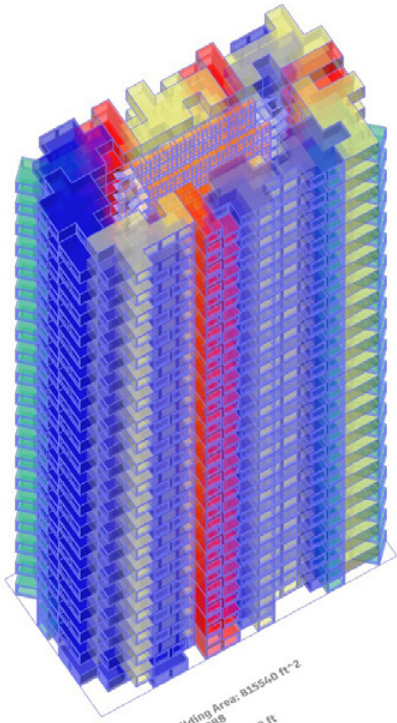


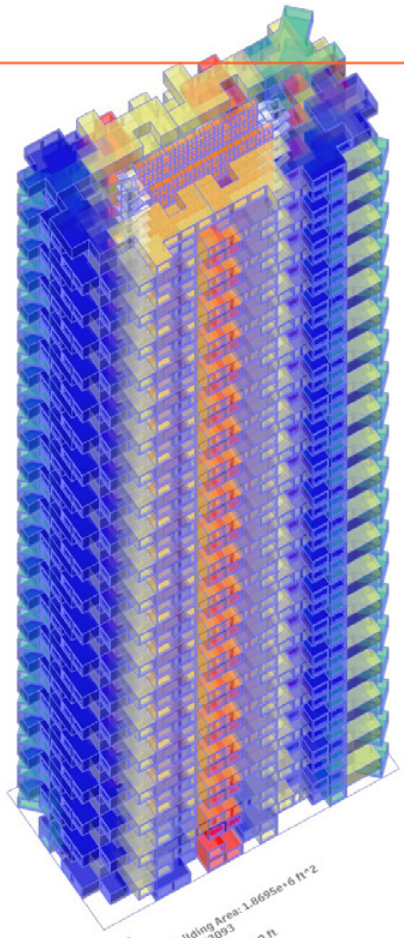
LEVEL 5 FLOOR PLAN

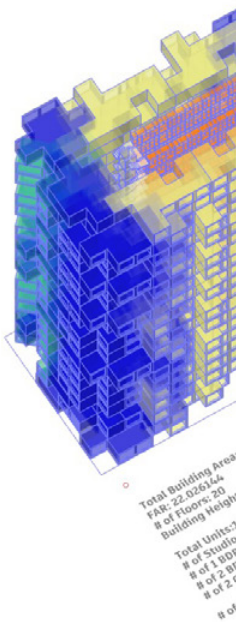

UP
UP

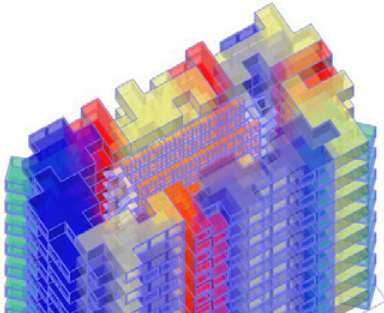
A Grasshopper script automates the placement of modular housing units across a site based on adjustable building heights and density goals. Each iteration evaluates FAR, unit count, total square footage, and storage capacity, supporting rapid exploration of massing and development scenarios.

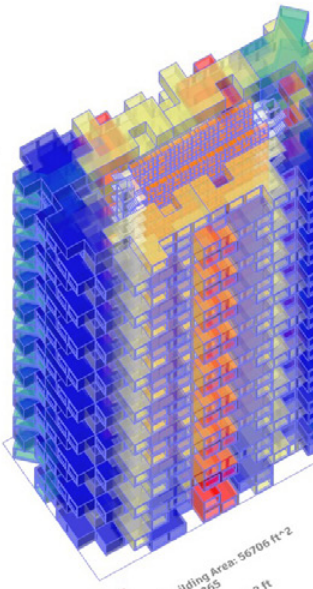


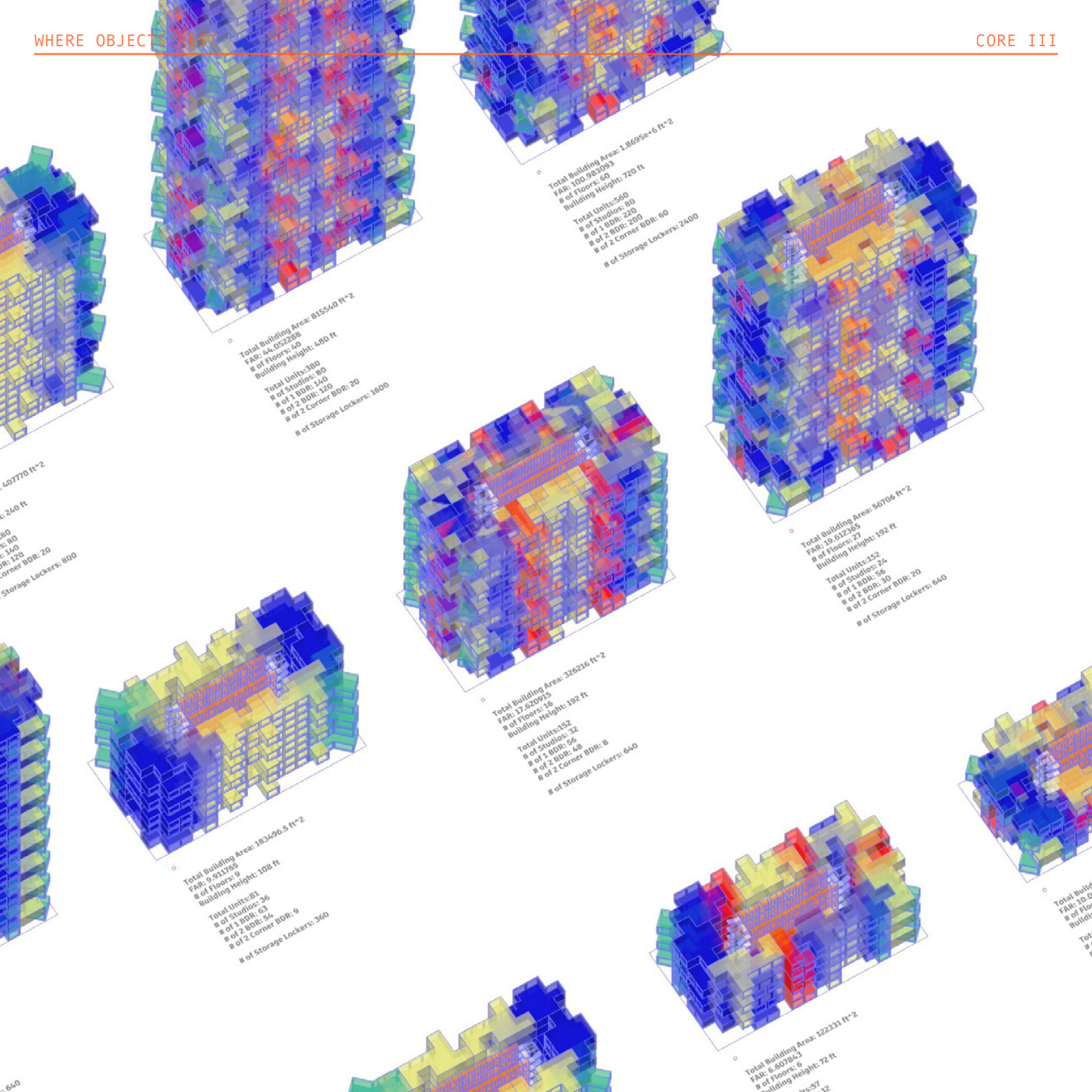











Total Building Area: 1.8695e+6 ft^2
FAR: 100.981093
# of Floors: 60
Building Height: 720 ft
Total Units:560
# of Studios: 80
of 1 BDR: 220
of 2 BDR: 200
of 2 Corner BDR: 60
of Storage Lockers: 2400
Total Building Area: 815540 ft^2
FAR: 44.052288
# of Floors: 40
Building Height: 480 ft
Total Units:380
# of Studios: 80
of 1 BDR: 140
of 2 BDR: 120
of 2 Corner BDR: 20
of Storage Lockers: 1600
Total Building Area: 56706 ft^2
FAR: 19.612365
# of Floors: 27
Building Height: 192 ft
Total Units:152
# of Studios: 24
of 1 BDR: 56
of 2 BDR: 30
of 2 Corner BDR: 20
of Storage Lockers: 640
Total Building Area: 326216 ft^2
FAR: 17.620915
# of Floors: 16
Building Height: 192 ft
Total Units:152
# of Studios: 32
of 1 BDR: 56
of 2 BDR: 48
of 2 Corner BDR: 8
of Storage Lockers: 640
Total Building Area: 183496.5 ft^2
FAR: 9.911765
# of Floors: 9
Building Height: 108 ft
Total Units:81
# of Studios: 36
of 1 BDR: 63
of 2 BDR: 54
of 2 Corner BDR: 9
of Storage Lockers: 360
Total Building Area: 122331 ft^2
FAR: 6.607843
# of Floors: 6
Building Height: 72 ft

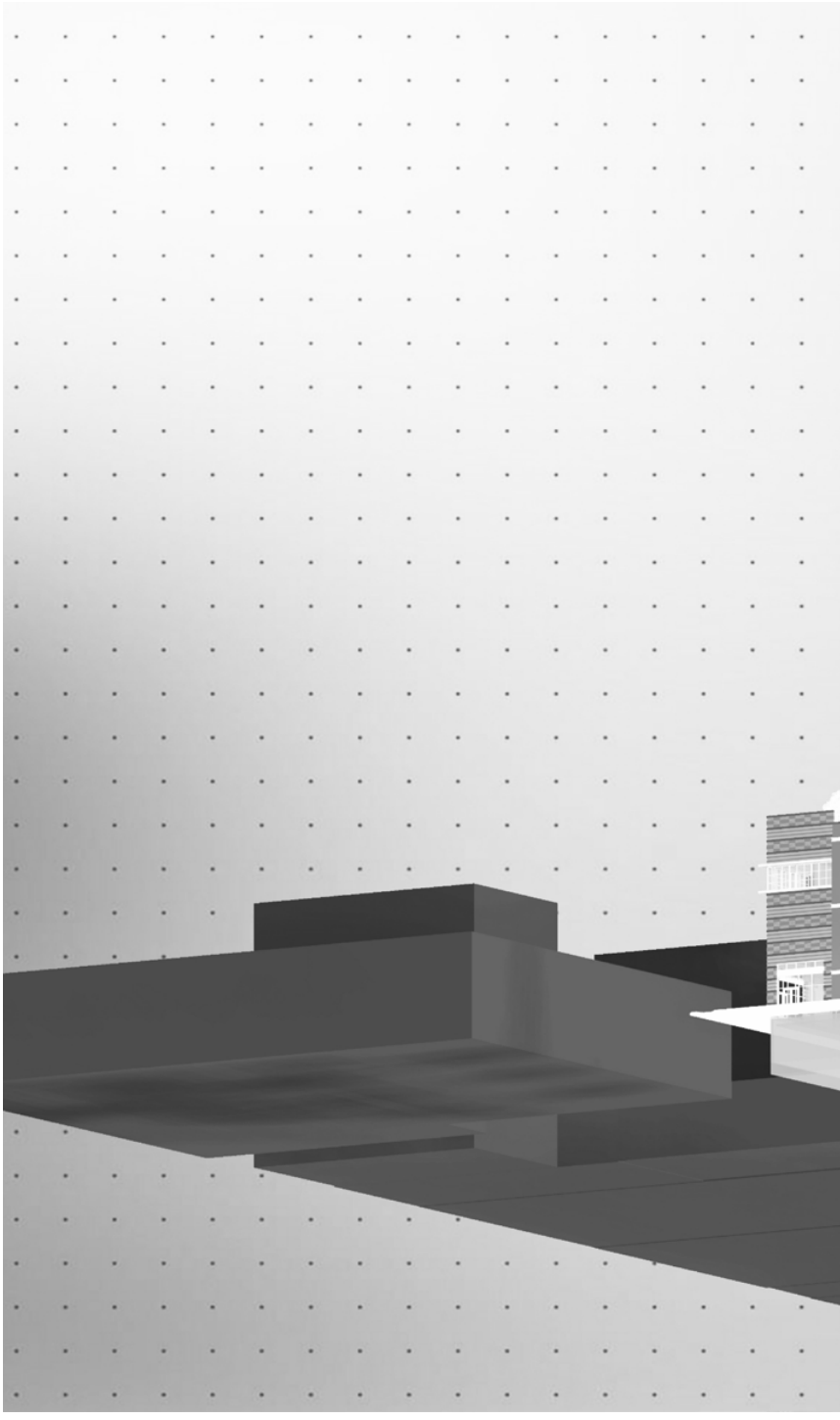
125 CORNER UNIVERSITY

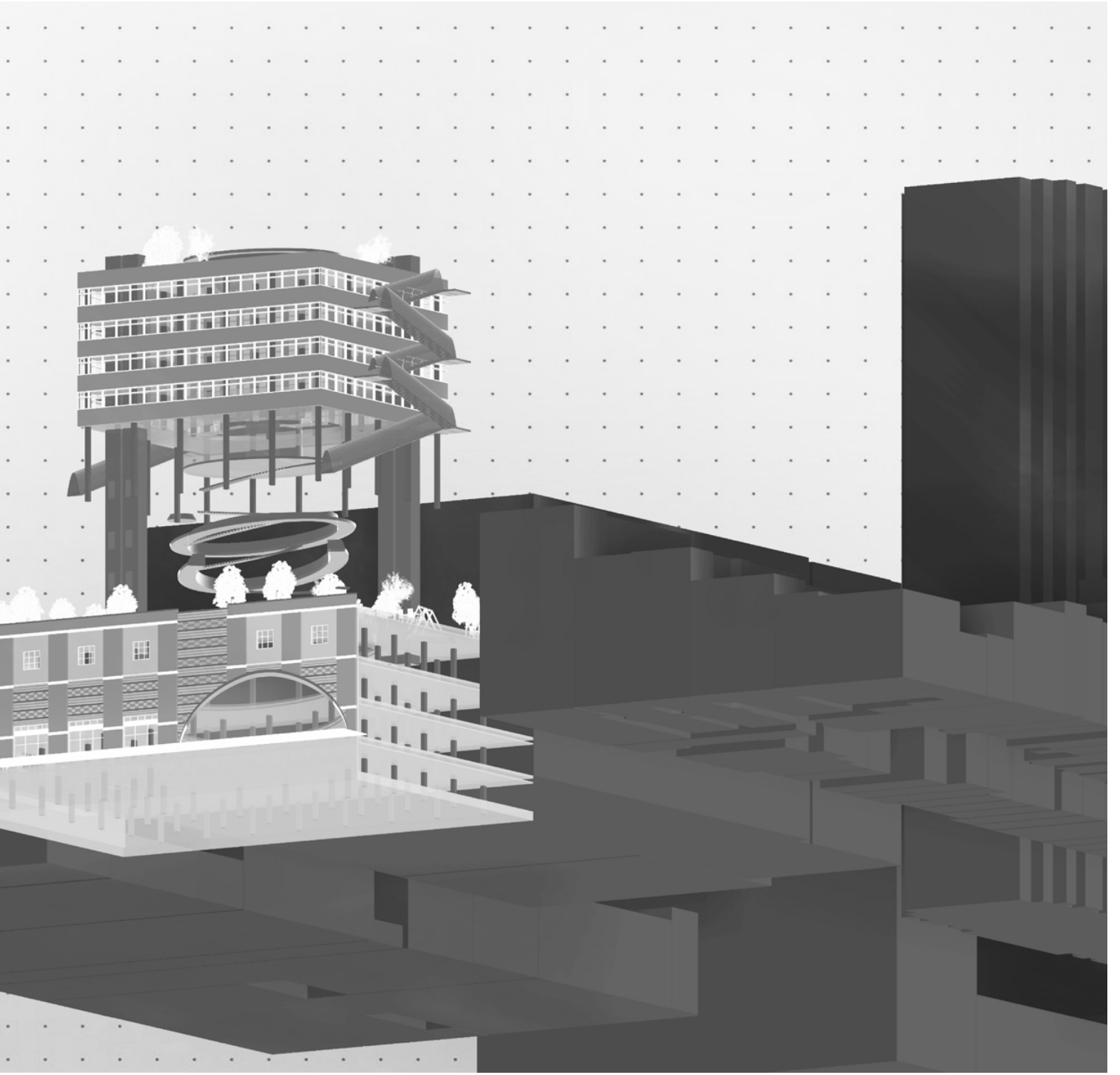
SEMESTER:
Core I “Fujitive Mobilities”
Fall 2023

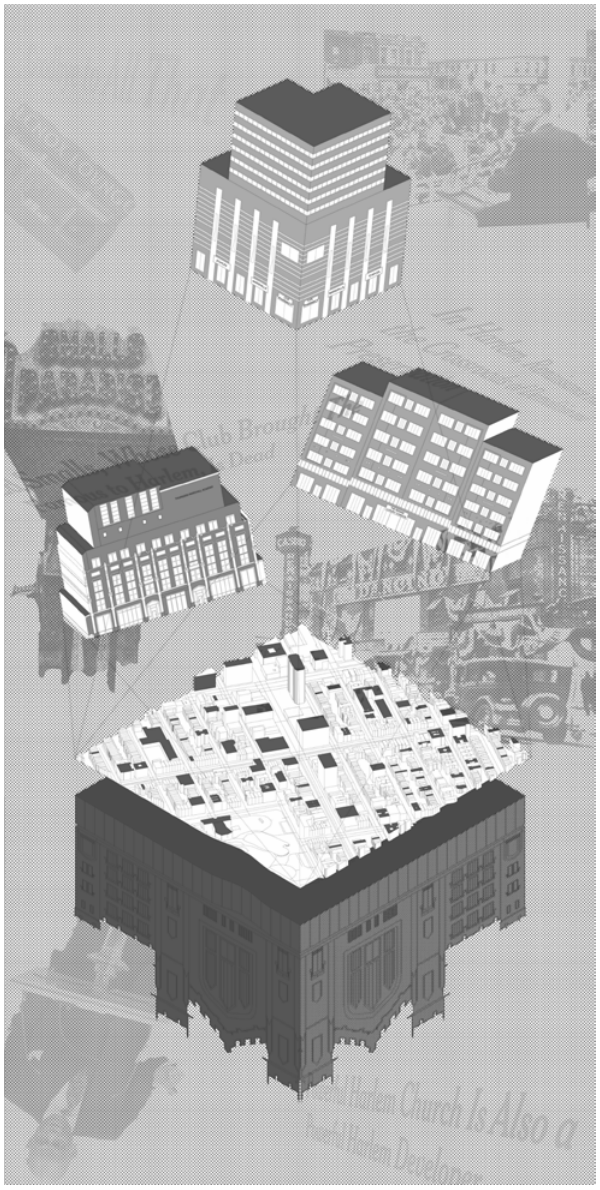
SITE:
Harlem, NYC

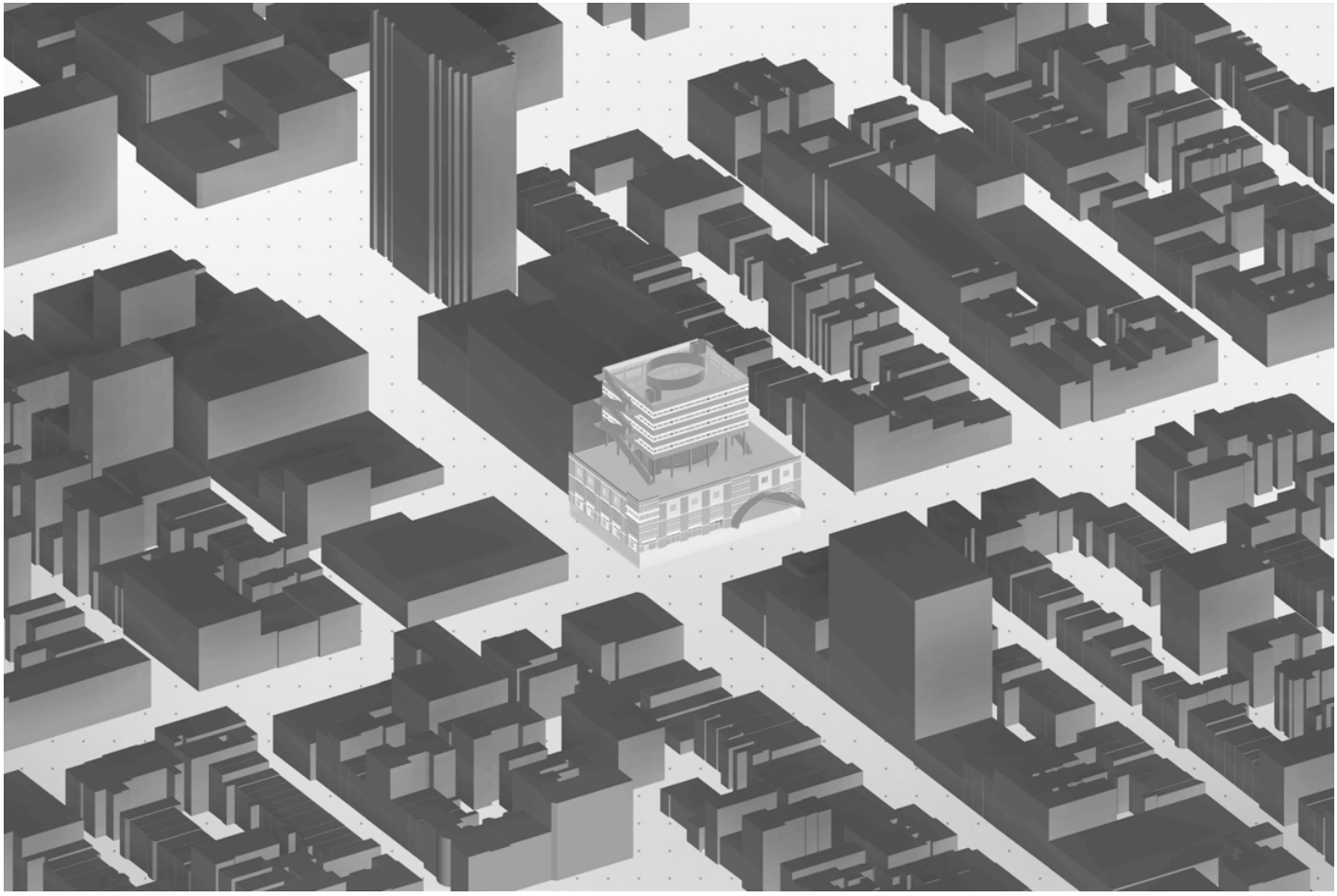
INSTRUCTOR:
Galen Pardee

Originally built in 2001 by the Abyssinian Development Corporation as a big box retail and office complex, 125 Corner University reimagines this building as a vertical neighborhood: a stacked civic institution that serves every member of the Harlem community within a single structure. Inspired by the historical Street Corner University, the program layers retail at grade with social services, legal defense, family counseling, disability assistance, and intergenerational recreation above. A green terrace anchors the building as a shared public threshold between the commercial floors below and the community institutions above. The building does not ask residents to seek out resources across the borough. It gathers them here, at the corner.

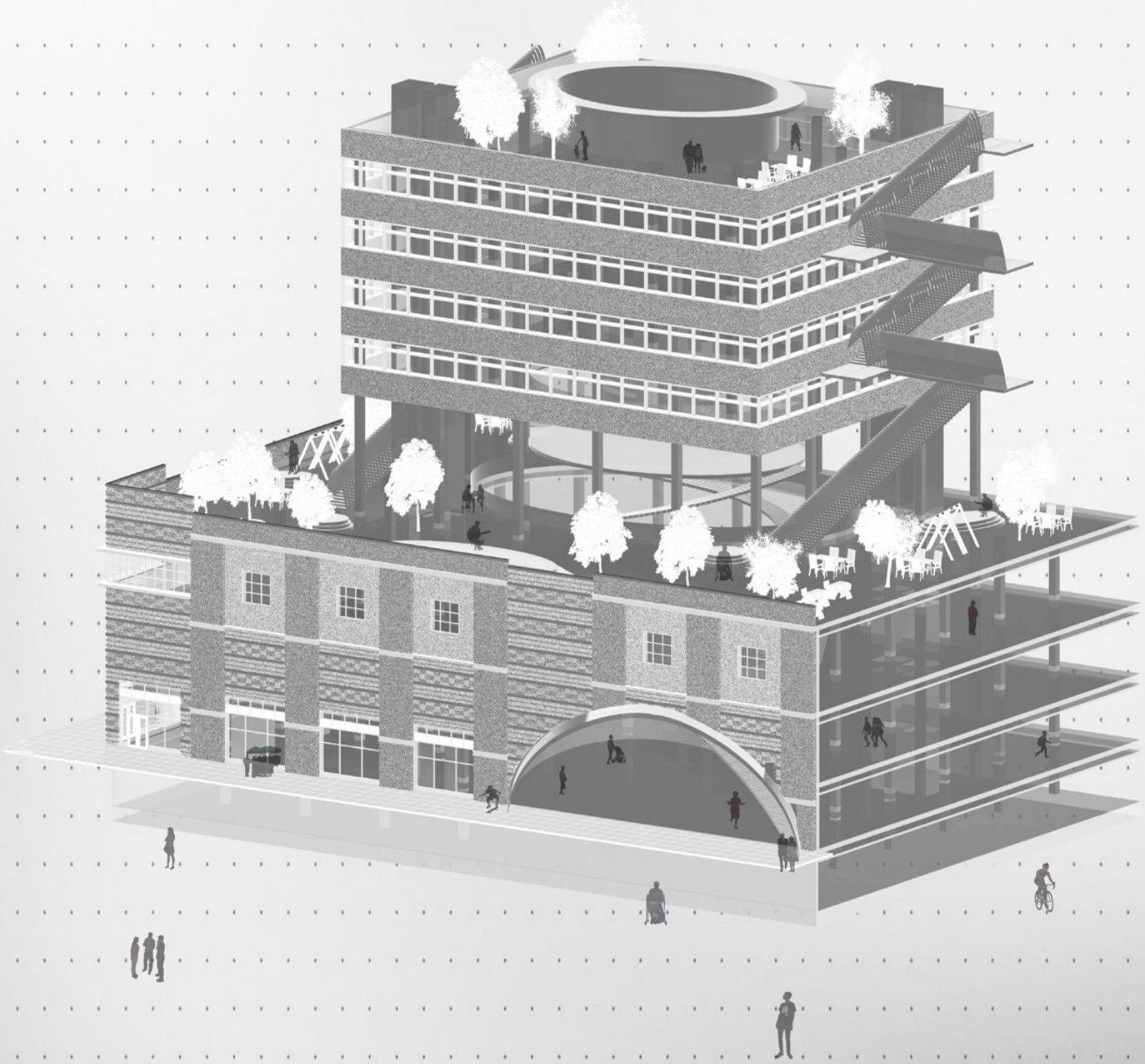





SMALL
PARADISE
DE NORD
Church Is Also a



The Abyssinian Development Corporation built this building to rebuild the social and physical capital of Harlem. What opened was a Marshalls, a CVS, and a Dunkin Donuts. 125 Corner University returns the building to that original mission, stacking the services the community actually needs above the retail that got built instead.



THANK YOU!